World Health Organization

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

Report of the 18th FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management

Geneva, Switzerland and online, 7–10 October 2025

World Health Organization

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

Report of the 18th FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management

Geneva, Switzerland and online, 7–10 October 2025

Report of the 18th FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management, Geneva, Switzerland and online, 7-10 October 2025

ISBN (WHO) 978-92-4-012096-9 (electronic version)
ISBN (WHO) 978-92-4-012097-6 (print version)
ISBN (FAO) 978-92-5-140470-6

© World Health Organization and Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations, 2026

Some rights reserved. This work is available under the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 3.0 IGO licence (CC BY-NC-SA 3.0 IGO; https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/3.0/igo/).

Under the terms of this licence, you may copy, redistribute and adapt the work for non-commercial purposes, provided the work is appropriately cited, as indicated below. In any use of this work, there should be no suggestion that the World Health Organization (WHO) or the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) endorse any specific organization, products or services. The use of the WHO or FAO logo is not permitted. If you adapt the work, then you must license your work under the same or equivalent Creative Commons licence. If you create a translation of this work, you should add the following disclaimer along with the suggested citation: "This translation was not created by the World Health Organization (WHO) or the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO). WHO and FAO are not responsible for the content or accuracy of this translation. The original English edition shall be the binding and authentic edition".

Any mediation relating to disputes arising under the licence shall be conducted in accordance with the mediation rules of the World Intellectual Property Organization http://www.wipo.int/amc/en/mediation/rules.

Suggested citation. Report of the 18th FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management, Geneva, Switzerland and online, 7–10 October 2025. Geneva: World Health Organization and Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations; 2026. Licence: CC BY-NC-SA 3.0 IGO.

Cataloguing-in-Publication (CIP) data. CIP data are available at https://iris.who.int/.

Sales, rights and licensing. To purchase WHO publications, see https://www.who.int/publications/book-orders. To submit requests for commercial use and queries on rights and licensing, see https://www.who.int/about/policies/publishing/copyright.

Third-party materials. If you wish to reuse material from this work that is attributed to a third party, such as tables, figures or images, it is your responsibility to determine whether permission is needed for that reuse and to obtain permission from the copyright holder. The risk of claims resulting from infringement of any third-party-owned component in the work rests solely with the user.

The designations employed and the presentation of the material in this publication do not imply the expression of any opinion whatsoever on the part of WHO or FAO concerning the legal or development status of any country, territory, city or area or of its authorities, or concerning the delimitation of its frontiers or boundaries. Dotted lines on maps represent approximate border lines for which there may not yet be full agreement.

The mention of specific companies or of certain manufacturers' products, whether or not these have been patented, does not imply that they are endorsed or recommended by WHO or FAO in preference to others of a similar nature that are not mentioned. Errors and omissions excepted, the names of proprietary products are distinguished by initial capital letters.

All reasonable precautions have been taken by WHO and FAO to verify the information contained in this publication. However, the published material is being distributed without warranty of any kind, either expressed or implied. The responsibility for the interpretation and use of the material lies with the reader. In no event shall WHO and FAO be liable for damages arising from its use.

This publication contains the report of the 18th FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management and does not necessarily represent the decisions or policies of WHO or FAO.

Contents

ABBREVIATIONS ..... **V**

1. INTRODUCTION **1**

2. OPENING SESSION **2**

2.1 Opening of the meeting 2
2.2 Declarations of interest 3
2.3 Appointment of Chairperson, Co-Chairperson and Rapporteurs 3
2.4 Adoption of the agenda 3
2.5 Meeting procedure 3

3. SUMMARY OF DEVELOPMENTS AND ACTIONS SINCE THE 17TH JOINT MEETING ON PESTICIDE MANAGEMENT **4**

4. STATUS OF FOLLOW-UP ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE RECOMMENDATIONS OF THE 17TH JOINT MEETING ON PESTICIDE MANAGEMENT **9**

5. REVIEW OF THE CODE OF CONDUCT FOR INCLUSION OF THE FREE, PRIOR AND INFORMED CONSENT FOR INDIGENOUS PEOPLES **11**

6. REVISION OF EXISTING GUIDANCE **13**

6.1 Guidance on developing a reporting system for health and environmental incidents resulting from exposure to pesticides 13
6.2 Guidance on management options for empty pesticide containers 15

7. REVIEW OF NEW GUIDANCE UNDER DEVELOPMENT **18**

7.1 Guidance note on application of pesticides by drones 18
7.2 Guidance note on registration of minor use pesticides 19
7.3 Glossary of terms and definitions on pesticide management 20

8. EMERGING AND PRIORITY ISSUES IN PESTICIDE MANAGEMENT AND PLANNING THE DEVELOPMENT OF NEW GUIDANCE **22**

8.1 Prioritization of emerging issues 22
8.2 Guidance on risk communication on pesticides 23
8.3 Guidance on monitoring and management of pesticide resistance 23

9. OPERATION OF THE JOINT MEETING ON PESTICIDE MANAGEMENT **25**

9.1 Terms of Reference of the JMPM 25
9.2 Standard operating procedure for the development of guidance 25
9.3 Action Plan for the Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management 26

10. OTHER ISSUES **27**

10.1 Request regarding Decision of the Rotterdam Convention (RC)-12/5 27
10.2 Toolkit on risk evaluation methodology for the Rotterdam Convention 28
10.3 Communication strategy 29
10.4 Coordination with the Joint Meeting on Pesticide Residuesand the Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management 29
10.5 Miscellaneous issues 29

11. RECOMMENDATIONS **30**

Revision of the Code of Conduct 30
Reporting systems for health and environmental incidents 30
Management options for empty pesticide containers 30
Application of pesticides by drones 31
Registration of minor use pesticides 31

Risk communication 31
Pesticide resistance 31
Glossary of terms and definitions 31
Operation of JMPM 32
Other issues 32

12. CLOSING 33

ANNEX 1. ADOPTED AGENDA 34

ANNEX 2. LIST OF PARTICIPANTS 37

ANNEX 3. REPORT OF REVIEWING THE INTERNATIONAL CODE OF CONDUCT ON PESTICIDE MANAGEMENT REGARDING THE FREE, PRIOR AND INFORMED CONSENT OF INDIGENOUS PEOPLES 41

Abbreviations

BAT	best available techniques
BEP	best environmental practices
CLI	CropLife International
CSO	civil society organization
COAG	Committee on Agriculture
COP	Conference of the Parties
DDT	Dichlorodiphenyltrichloroethane
EAC	East Africa Community
EPPO	European and Mediterranean Plant Protection Organization
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
FPIC	free, prior and informed consent
GEF	Global Environment Facility
GFC	Global Framework on Chemicals
HHP	highly hazardous pesticide
IBMA	International Biocontrol Manufacturers Association
IITC	International Indian Treaty Council
IPEN	International Pollutants Elimination Network
IPM	integrated pest management
ISO	International Organization for Standardization
ITN	insecticide-treated net
IVM	integrated vector management
JMPM	FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management
JMPR	FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Residues
JMPS	FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Specifications
LMIC	low- and middle-income country
NGO	non-governmental organization
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
PAN	Pesticide Action Network
PIC	prior informed consent
POP	Persistent Organic Pollutant
RNAi	RNA interference
SADC	Southern Africa Development Community
SDG	Sustainable Development Goal
SOP	standard operating procedure
SPMF	Sustainable Pesticide Management Framework (CropLife International)
UK	United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
UNEP	United Nations Environment Programme
WHO	World Health Organization

1. Introduction

The 18th Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO)/World Health Organization (WHO) Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management (JMPM) was hosted by the WHO at its headquarters in Geneva, Switzerland, on 7–10 October 2025. It was a hybrid meeting, attended by FAO and WHO panel experts, observers and invited experts, in which participants met physically or joined online.

The meeting agenda included the following topics:

- summary of developments and actions since the 17th JMPM meeting in 2024;
- status of follow-up actions taken on the recommendations of the 17th JMPM meeting;
- review of the *International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management* ("Code of Conduct") at the request of COAG 29 for the inclusion of free, prior and informed consent (FPIC) for Indigenous Peoples;[1]
- revision of existing guidance;
- review of new guidance under development;
- emerging and priority issues and planning the development of new guidance;
- review and endorsement of Terms of Reference of the JMPM;
- review and endorsement of standard operating procedures (SOP) for the development of guidance; and
- any other issues.

The recommendations from the 18th JMPM are presented under each relevant section, and a full list is provided in Section 11 of this report.

2. Opening session

2.1 Opening of the meeting

Raman Velayudhan (Coordinator, Veterinary Public Health, Vector Control and Environment Unit, Malaria and Neglected Tropical Diseases Department of WHO) welcomed the JMPM participants on behalf of the Secretariat of the JMPM. A round of introductions was made by the participants. Baogen Gu (Senior Agricultural Officer, Pest and Pesticide Management of FAO) introduced two newly selected FAO panel members, Mengmeng Qu (China) and Ashley Nelsen (United States of America). There were no new WHO panel members.

Maru Agregawi Weldedawit (Head, Vectors, Disease Control, Elimination and Eradication across sectors Unit of WHO) delivered his opening remarks on behalf of the WHO. He pointed out the concern about insecticide resistance and the growing impact of climate change regarding vector-borne diseases. Pesticide management involves the reduction of risks for human health, animal health and the environment while effectively controlling vectors and pests. WHO works across multiple vectors to address the challenge of insecticide resistance and to ensure that different tools and insecticide classes are available to overcome these problems across diseases. Rising malaria cases in high-burden countries in Africa are partly attributable to insecticide resistance. Climate change has affected the geographic expansion of disease vectors, leading to the spread of vector-borne diseases. Maru Agregawi Weldedawit emphasized the importance of the focused work of the JMPM to address these needs in a changing environment. This work includes the revision of the Code of Conduct, management of empty pesticide containers, pesticide application by drones, and other topics. WHO values the expertise of the participants in finding solutions to the challenges. He concluded his opening remarks by wishing the participants a fruitful meeting.

On behalf of FAO, Baogen Gu welcomed the participants and thanked them for their efforts and achievements since the 17th JMPM meeting. He particularly noted the progress made in reviewing the Code of Conduct regarding the FPIC of Indigenous Peoples, and progress regarding the development of new guidance documents. As global pesticide use is increasing, concern about their harmful effects is also rising. Recent progress has been made with respect to international agreements, such as: i) the Global Framework on Chemicals, with its target on the phasing out of highly hazardous pesticides (HHPs) where the risks have not been managed and where safer and affordable alternatives are available, and to promote transition to and make available those alternatives[2]; ii) the efforts of FAO to support the *Resolution V11* at the Fifth Session of the International Conference of Chemicals management on the establishment of the Global Alliance on HHPs[3]; and iii) the Kunming-Montreal Biodiversity Framework, with its target to reduce pollution from all sources, including pesticides taking into account food security and livelihoods to levels that are not harmful to biodiversity[4]. FAO continued to support Member Nations on transforming towards sustainable agrifood systems which requires the strengthening of pesticide lifecycle management. Moreover, emerging pesticide technologies, such as RNAi-based (gene-specific

silencing) products and the use of artificial intelligence, are posing new opportunities to manage and reduce pesticide risks.

The Memorandum of Understanding between FAO, WHO and the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) on matters regarding the JMPM is being processed for signature by the three agencies. It is anticipated that UNEP will join the JMPM Secretariat before the next JMPM meeting in 2026. With UNEP's joining, the mandate of the JMPM will remain unchanged. After signing, the FAO/WHO JMPM will effectively become the FAO/UNEP/WHO JMPM.

2.2 Declarations of interest

FAO and WHO reviewed the declarations of interest from their respective JMPM panel members participating in the 18th JMPM meeting and concluded that none could give rise to a potential or reasonably perceived conflict of interest related to any items on the meeting agenda. Observers are not required to declare any conflict of interest for their participation in JMPM meetings and their related work.

2.3 Appointment of Chairperson, Co-Chairperson and Rapporteurs

Nosiku Munyinda (WHO panel member, University of Zambia) was nominated as the Chairperson of the meeting, and Helena Casabona (FAO panel member, Swedish Chemicals Agency) was nominated as Co-Chairperson. Shumirayi Muhera (FAO Plant Production and Protection Division) and Rajpal Yadav (WHO Temporary Adviser, India) were appointed as Rapporteurs. Henk van den Berg (Wageningen University, Kingdom of the Netherlands) was appointed as the report writer.

2.4 Adoption of the agenda

No adjustments were made to the agenda for the meeting, and the agenda was adopted by the participants as presented in Annex 1.

2.5 Meeting procedure

Several participants joined online (see List of participants, Annex 2). The procedure for in-person and online participation, and the procedure allowing panel members to provide their comments before observers, were explained. An online folder was used to share the available documents and presentations of the meeting among participants. The meeting was recorded for reporting purposes only.[a]

[a] Recordings were deleted after acceptance of the report.

3. Summary of developments and actions since the 17th Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management

Representatives of organizations/institutions that participated in the meeting presented an overview of their activities in relation to pesticide management during the past year.

World Health Organization

The WHO's work consisted of several components:

- Richard Brown (WHO Chemicals, Radiation and Health Unit) explained that his Unit contributed to the Global Alliance on HHPs, *inter alia* by selecting an interim steering committee to operationalize the alliance; updating the *WHO Recommended Classification of Pesticides by Hazard*; and commissioning a situation analysis on reporting systems for environmental and health pesticide incidents.
- Rajpal Yadav (Temporary Adviser, WHO) presented that, since the 17th JMPM, four new guidance documents have been published, and the global map of insecticide resistance data in disease vectors has been updated. In the past year, the WHO prequalified four insecticide-treated net (ITN) products, two spatial repellent products and two indoor residual spraying products. WHO conducted a systematic evidence review on the effectiveness of disinfection of conveyances to prevent or reduce the spread of mosquito vectors via international travel. In the WHO Regions, progress has been made in relation to vector-borne disease control, vector control needs assessment, entomological surveillance, insecticide resistance monitoring, capacity strengthening, and new technologies.
- Emmanuel Chanda (WHO Malaria and Neglected Tropical Diseases Department) added that WHO convened meetings of the Vector Control Advisory Group to evaluate eight new vector control interventions, but after the last meeting, the committee was dissolved. WHO's guidelines on malaria were updated to include recommendations about the newly prequalified vector control products and interventions. A multi-centre study was conducted to establish the discriminating concentration of new insecticides for insecticide resistance monitoring. Moreover, WHO conducted technical consultations on invasive malaria vectors, ITNs, and indoor residual spraying.
- Regarding arboviral diseases, Raman Velayudhan reported that the global trend showed a large increase in dengue cases in 2024. Chikungunya is re-emerging in various countries. WHO commissioned a study on the impact of climate change on dengue, concluding that the complex effects of climate change call for tailored interventions, supported by improved monitoring and infrastructure. WHO is also addressing the linkages between dengue and urbanization.

Food and Agriculture Organization

Baogen Gu presented the progress made by FAO:

- FAO together with WHO supported the review of the Code of Conduct regarding the inclusion of the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples, which included a global questionnaire survey and consultation with stakeholders (see Section 5).
- Four FAO/WHO guidance documents have been published, and four new ones are being developed. FAO continued its normative work on pesticide specifications and residue standards through the FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Specifications (JMPS) and the FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Residues (JMPR).
- Regarding capacity building, several regional and national trainings were conducted on the *FAO Pesticide Toolkit*, waste management and biopesticides. Up to now, over 900 pesticide registration officers from 93 countries have been trained. New training modules for the Toolkit were developed. Substantial support for capacity-building was provided to the pesticide registration scheme among countries in the Caribbean, East Africa Community (EAC), Southern Africa Development Community (SADC), and the Pacific.
- FAO conducted several activities on pesticide risk reduction, to address the HHPs and to promote safer alternatives, and to raise awareness about antimicrobial resistance in plant protection. Integrated pest management (IPM) was promoted through the publication of new guidance and capacity-building.
- FAO together with other UN agencies facilitated the establishment of the Global Alliance on HHPs. In addition, FAO facilitated the development of a headline indicator for monitoring Target 7.2 of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework.

Rotterdam Convention

Frederike Breuer (Rotterdam Convention Secretariat, FAO) presented that, at the Twelfth Conference of the Parties (COP), 15 decisions were adopted, including the listing of new chemicals. The Chemicals Review Committee reviewed notifications for regulatory actions, proposing the listing of severely hazardous pesticide formulations. Also, the Committee revised the report form for human health incidents and harmonized it with the environmental incident report form.

Regarding *Decision RC-12/5 on enhancing the effectiveness of the Rotterdam Convention*, item 5, the Rotterdam Convention has invited the JMPM to discuss, as appropriate, the use of Annex III as a criterion for defining HHPs under Criterion 6 of the *Guidelines on Highly Hazardous Pesticides* of the Code of Conduct.

United Nations Environment Programme

Mihaela Paun (Chemical and Health branch, UNEP) explained that UNEP's Knowledge and Risk Unit focuses on providing decision makers with the science and tools for the sound management of chemicals and waste. UNEP completed the report on the environmental and health impacts of pesticides and fertilizers, and the recommendations of the report have been integrated into UNEP's Food Systems Strategy. A progress report on UNEP's work in HHPs has been prepared and put forward for consideration at the seventh meeting of the United Nations Environmental Assembly (UNEA-7). Moreover, UNEP has a mandate following the adoption of *Resolution V/11* under the Global Framework on Chemicals (GFC) and is working under the leadership of FAO, together with other UN agencies, to establish the Global Alliance on HHPs. The GFC Fund has recently approved two projects focusing specifically on HHPs. Ongoing projects, financed by the UNEP Special Programme, in Armenia, El Salvador, the Gambia, Mongolia, Morocco and the Republic of Moldova, are focusing on improving chemical safety and management, including activities related to hazardous substances and HHPs. Under the Stockholm Convention, UNEP supports over 32 countries to update their National Implementation Plans, which include the development of inventories and action plans for Persistent Organic Pollutants (POPs). UNEP also supported Namibia and Uganda to develop a national roadmap for the development of alternatives to Dichlorodiphenyltrichloroethane (DDT). UNEP coordinates the global monitoring of Persistent Organic Pollutants (POPs) in samples of air, water and human milk. UNEP implements several other UNEP/Global Environment Facility (GEF) projects on pesticide management. UNEP further collaborates with academia and non-governmental organizations on pesticide suicide prevention and on the transition from HHPs to biopesticides.

Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development

Jane Richardson gave an overview of the work on pesticides of the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD). In an annual seminar on biopesticides, three topics were addressed: i) peptides of plant protection products; ii) re-examination of the taxonomy of *Bacillus thuringiensis*; and iii) guidance on semiochemicals. A new project has started on the risk assessment of biopesticides.

The expert group on residue chemistry is working on several guidance documents.

OECD continued to work on pesticide application by drone technology. There have been several field trials to generate data on drift from drones; these data will be combined with published data for a comprehensive review. A study on operator exposure from drones is being planned. OECD's Drone/Uncrewed Aerial Spray Systems subgroup is evaluating spray drift and an industry task force has developed best practices on drones. Jane Richardson emphasized that collaboration on drones between agencies will be important. OECD is also working on digital labels for pesticides to improve user-friendliness and to reduce misuse and incidents. Some countries already implement digital labels, and the next step is to align approaches. The meeting of the network on the illegal trade of pesticides is to be held in November 2025.

Pesticide Action Network/International Pollutants Elimination Network

Tadesse Amera (Pesticide Action Network [PAN]-Ethiopia and International Pollutants Elimination Network [IPEN]) presented the ongoing work on replacing pesticides with agroecology in cotton and vegetables through the farmer field school approach. Several civil society organizations (CSOs) are collaborating to promote implementation of the Global Framework on Chemicals (GFC), which includes two HHP-related projects in West Africa and East Africa with funding by the GFC.

Sheila Willis (PAN, UK) noted that PAN has scaled up farmer training in Benin by supporting 9 000 farmers in their organic cotton production, with good return on investment, whilst preparing a GEF project with UNEP to extend support services to 42 000 farmers over 5 years. Data on acute pesticide poisoning have continued to be collected from 12 countries using PAN's mobile app. Sheila Willis stated that the app addresses a data gap in poisoning incidents, with PAN concluding that over 75 percent of incidents are missed by health services. PAN uses the data to support national regulators and others to reduce HHPs in supply chains. The data are also used by PAN to identify HHPs according to criterion 8, to identify high-risk groups for exposure, and to measure effectiveness of mitigation measures. PAN recently published pesticide poisoning data from studies in Tanzania and in Trinidad and Jamaica, indicating that half of the farmers reported ill-effects each year caused by only a few insecticide products. The data indicated that farmer training on the use of personal protective equipment only marginally reduced poisoning incidents.

PAN developed information resources to support practitioners and supported the implementation of key targets and activities under several pesticide international conventions and agreements. Sheila Willis noted the potential value of the JMPM guidance incorporating a standard form of words that recognizes the relevant parts of the Bonn Declaration (Target A7 and D5), the establishment of the GFC including the Global Alliance on HHPs, and the relevant commitments made in the Kunming-Montreal Biodiversity Framework (Targets 7 and 10).

CropLife International

Andrew Ward of CropLife International (CLI) described how CLI's Sustainable Pesticide Management Framework (SPMF) is working holistically to bring about the responsible and sustainable management of pests. Activities under the SPMF include capacity building on risk assessment and risk mitigation, technical cooperation, information sharing and supply chain integration. CLI supports regional harmonization and data sharing for more efficient risk assessment and biopesticide registration. CLI has pioneered Mode-of-Action labelling for pesticide resistance management at the farmer level, which has become mandatory in various countries. Other activities include pesticide container management showing that the collection of packaging waste increased substantially, reaching a 65 percent collection rate where there is a collection scheme in place. CLI noted that only 69 countries have such a scheme in place.

In response to a question from another panel member on whether CLI collects empty containers only of their own products, CLI responded that this is not the case; CLI is working with AgroCare towards a full industry approach to collect containers irrespective of the company.

Biocontrol Manufacturers Association

Jennifer Lewis, representing the International Biocontrol Manufacturers Association (IBMA), explained that her organization covers products including invertebrates, microbials, semiochemicals and natural substances that are used in agroecology and IPM. The IBMA works on training and knowledge transfer of farmers to adopt the use of biopesticides in their crops. The IBMA published a risk assessment decision tree for microbials when used in plant protection. She also noted that biocontrol registration timelines are relatively long in Europe, compared to elsewhere, but the European Commission has proposed to accelerate this process.

AgroCare

Wang Yue of AgroCare, a global association representing more than 800 independent post-patent (generic) crop protection companies, expressed that due to the restructuring of AgroCare, the association could not participate in recent JMPM meetings, but is expected to be present in future meetings, now that the restructuring is being finalized.

4. Status of follow-up actions taken on the recommendations of the 17th Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management

Shumirayi Muhera presented a summary of the follow-up action plan after the 17th JMPM meeting in October 2024, and outlined the actions taken since then, as follows:

- Regarding the recommendation that the work on developing guidance on risk communication be expedited, this work was put on hold.
- Regarding the recommendation to pursue revision of the *Guidelines on management options for empty pesticide containers* (2008 edition), a working group with a Chairperson was set up, and a meeting was held to discuss the way forward, which includes hiring a consultant to conduct a gap analysis.
- Regarding the recommendation to revisit the existing *Guidelines on Prevention and Management of Pesticide Resistance* (2012 edition), this work was put on hold.
- Regarding the recommendation for developing guidance on minor use of pesticides, three participants showed interest in joining a working group, and an outline was produced by the Minor Use Foundation to serve as a background information document.
- Regarding the recommendations to prepare clean versions of the *Guidance note on the online sale of pesticides* and the *Guidance note on addressing the illegal trade of pesticides*, these two documents have been endorsed and published.
- Regarding the recommendation to prepare a clean version of the *Guidance on data requirements for the registration of pesticides*, WHO is in the process of obtaining publication clearances, after which it will be published.
- Regarding the recommendation to conduct the gap analysis of the Code of Conduct in relation to Indigenous Peoples issues, a road map and concept note were developed, a legal document was prepared and reviewed, a global questionnaire survey was conducted, and the working group drafted a full and a summary report.
- Regarding the recommendation to make available to the JMPM the results of a situation analysis of existing reporting systems for environmental and human health pesticide incidents, the working group has met, a consultant was hired by WHO to assist with the desk review, interviews and analysis, and a report was developed.
- Regarding the recommendation to organize the JMPM action plan document, this work is ongoing.
- Regarding the recommendation to revisit the text on gender mainstreaming for future JMPM guidance documents, this work was put on hold.

- Regarding the recommendation to distribute JMPM meeting documents at least two weeks before meetings, this was implemented for the intersessional and main meetings and will be a standard process.
- Regarding the recommendation to allow JMPM panel members the opportunity to review and endorse final JMPM annual meeting reports, this was implemented for the report of the 17th meeting and will be a standard process.
- Regarding the recommendations to consider the number of observer organizations in JMPM meetings, to have a procedure for the participation of observers in the JMPM meetings, and to structure the future JMPM engagements, these items have been included in the *Terms of Reference for the JMPM*, drafts of which were shared before the 18th JMPM for comments and endorsement.
- Regarding the recommendation to develop a formal standard process for developing JMPM guidance documents, and to provide instructions for commenting on JMPM documents, these items have been included in the *Standard operating procedure for the development of guidance on pesticide management*, drafts of which were shared before the 18th JMPM for comments and endorsement.

5. Review of the Code of Conduct for inclusion of the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples

Baogen Gu provided the background information on the review of the Code of Conduct in relation to the inclusion of free, prior and informed consent (FPIC) of Indigenous Peoples. In 2022, the United Nations Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues called on FAO and WHO to review the Code of Conduct to better reflect Indigenous Peoples' rights. In response, FAO's Committee on Agriculture (COAG) in its 29th Session in 2024 requested FAO and WHO to conduct a review of the Code of Conduct and assess the gaps regarding the FPIC of Indigenous Peoples through the JMPM and to present the evidence-based findings at the 30th Session of the COAG, due for submission in February 2026.[1] The 17th JMPM meeting in 2024, established a working group [b] to identify these gaps in the Code of Conduct. The working group began by developing a scope and road map for the work to be undertaken.

Concurrently, an FAO/WHO task force was formed by the JMPM Secretariat to support the working group. The task force, which included representatives of the JMPM Secretariat and legal and Indigenous Peoples units of FAO and WHO, conducted and documented a legal analysis on pesticide management and FPIC regarding Indigenous Peoples. The task force also carried out a global questionnaire survey among Indigenous Peoples to collect perspectives and experiences on pesticide management to be used for assessing whether FPIC of Indigenous Peoples has been respected.

The survey results of 273 respondents representing several regions, and other information and evidence, were reviewed in a meeting between the working group and the task force. Potential gaps within the Code of Conduct that could negatively affect the FPIC of Indigenous Peoples were identified. Based on the available documents and information, the working group prepared a report on the review of the Code of Conduct (presented in Annex 3) with recommendations for revisions to the Code of Conduct. Baogen Gu commended the working group and the task force for their productive work within a tight timeline.

Joseph Morrall, as Chairperson of the working group on the Code of Conduct, thanked the group members and the task force for their support and commitment, and the International Indian Treaty Council (IITC) for its foundational work. The working group had several online meetings. Joseph Morrall reported on the conclusions of the review and on the draft report for FAO and WHO.

The working group noted that the Code of Conduct and its guidance are intended to apply equally to all people, including Indigenous Peoples. The working group also noted that a major challenge has been the lack of available monitoring systems and the shortage of available reports comparing the situation of Indigenous Peoples with that of other peoples. Several gaps were identified where FPIC of Indigenous Peoples could be strengthened or made more explicit. The gaps, listed in Attachment 1 of the full report, include proposed

b JMPM working group members are Helena Casabona, Jamal Hajjar, Rorisang Mantutle, Joseph Morrall (Chairperson), Nosiku Munyinda, Ashley Nelsen, and Andre Peralta.

definitions for inclusion in the Code of Conduct. Without diminishing the reports that the working group received of personal experiences by Indigenous Peoples, they could not conclude, based on the available data, that harms reported arose in and of themselves from inadequacy within pesticide management practices set out in the Code of Conduct. Nevertheless, the working group did conclude that explicit inclusion of FPIC of Indigenous Peoples would enhance the effectives of the Code of Conduct.

The report recommended that FAO and WHO act to address the identified gaps, and that FAO and WHO note the proposed amendments to address these gaps. The meeting commended the working group and task force for their impressive work.

Regarding the statement that the Code of Conduct applies equally to all peoples, including Indigenous Peoples, one observer noted that only Indigenous Peoples have been recognized as having a framework of collective rights that explicitly references FPIC for FPIC. Several participants pointed out that Finding 2 (paragraph 74) of the full report, regarding the link between pesticide management and reported harms requires rephrasing to improve clarity.

One panel member expressed concern with some parts of the legal analysis document produced by the task force, as being represented as being endorsed by either the working group or JMPM fully, rather than as a separate work product prepared for the working group's consideration amongst a range of other evidence sources. To resolve this the working group confirmed that the task force`s legal analysis was an internal document for the JMPM only and not for release, externally. A sentence was added in the report to point out the divergence in opinions between the JMPM working group and the task force. Edits were made to the texts and recommendations of the full report to reflect that the JMPM cannot directly engage with the COAG but only through FAO and WHO.

The JMPM then endorsed the report. The report will be sent for consultation to member countries for their comments. These comments will serve as information to the JMPM but will not be used to alter the endorsed report.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that the JMPM Secretariat release the endorsed *Report of Reviewing the International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management (ICCPM) regarding the free, prior and informed consent (FPIC) of Indigenous Peoples* for consultation.
- that the FAO/WHO task force collate and provide to the JMPM the responses from the consultation regarding the *Report of Reviewing the International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management (ICCPM) regarding the free, prior and informed consent (FPIC) of Indigenous Peoples*.

6. Revision of existing guidance

6.1 Guidance on developing a reporting system for health and environmental incidents resulting from exposure to pesticides

Progress regarding the development of reporting systems for health and environmental incidents resulting from exposure to pesticides was presented by Nosiku Munyinda as Chairperson of the working group[c]. The mandate for revision of the 2009 guideline was given at the 15th JMPM in 2022. The 17th JMPM in 2024 recommended that a situation analysis be conducted of existing reporting for the period since 2009.

The working group, in its first meeting, agreed that the scope should include both health and environmental incident reporting systems in one guidance document; increasing efficiency for registration bodies, reducing costs, and targeting multiple stakeholders. Further considerations were that the guidance should take a supply chain approach; use case studies to show best practices; focus on incidents but also document the immediate outcomes of those incidents (e.g. fatalities); focus on the "system" of reporting, rather than the data; and include occupational exposures and exposures of vulnerable populations. The scope of environmental incidents is still under discussion. Considering that a reporting form on pesticide incidents from HHPs is being developed independently under the Rotterdam Convention, it was proposed to include a representative in the working group.

WHO has engaged a consultant who conducted an online survey and analysis of existing reporting systems of health and environmental incidents, both for legal and illegal pesticide use. The working group convened to review the draft report by the consultant. The comments of the working group and WHO were used by the consultant to provide a final report.

The online survey had 31 responses from 21 countries, 18 of which were low- and middle-income countries (LMICs). Respondents included pesticide registration authorities, and ministries of health and the environment. Interviews were held with 36 people affiliated with incident reporting systems. In total, information was collected from 45 incident reporting systems, 30 percent of which were from LMICs.

Reporting systems were operated mostly at national or subnational level, with some operating at international level. Most systems covered pesticides as well as other chemicals, and were operated by government agencies, universities, hospitals, non-governmental organizations (NGOs) and the private sector. Only a few systems were based on a national regulatory instrument. Systems were operated by 1–15 people, including volunteers. Limited information was obtained on the "procedures" of incident reporting with little information on environmental incident reporting systems collected. No systems that reported both health and environmental pesticide incidents were identified. Dedicated funding for operating the

[c] Working group composed of Piumee Bandara, Nosiku Munyinda (Chairperson), Mihaela Paun, Mengmeng Qu, Andi Trisyono, Andrew Ward, and Sheila Willis.

reporting systems was a major challenge in most countries. Several systems did not provide a follow-up on reported incidents. Not all systems reported their results on a regular basis. Moreover, only a few systems were able to influence policy or decision-making on pesticides. In the report, the consultant had made several general recommendations regarding the need:

- to assess the local situation, actors and available resources;
- to build on existing structures;
- for reporting incidents to be covered by legislation; and
- to share the results of incident reporting with policymakers and the public.

In the discussion, one panel member mentioned that data on pesticide spills could possibly be collected from existing projects on obsolete pesticides, and from research, whilst information on pesticide suicide incidents could be collected from the Centre for Pesticide Suicide Prevention (University of Edinburgh) and other sources. He also noted that infrastructure for incident reporting is often very limited in LMICs. Several participants suggested that, where resources are limited, countries should combine incident reporting for pesticides with reporting on chemical incidents generally and industrial chemicals and build upon existing systems.

An observer noted that CLI uses incident reporting for targeting risk management and for evaluating the effectiveness of risk management. Further, he supported the inclusion of illegal pesticides, stating that 25–30 percent of pesticides sold are illegal products, noting that incident data on illegal products could be used to trace and punish the traders of these products. Another observer pointed out that data on poisoning incidents can be collected through self-reporting by farmers, by using a mobile app, and that such data could fill the gap between what farmers experience and what health services record.

A representative of the Rotterdam Convention explained that forms for health and environmental incident reporting are listed under Annex 3 of the Convention and apply to severely hazardous pesticide formulations; this term is used to differentiate the formulations from the HHP chemicals. Updated forms will be reissued by 2027. She emphasized the potential for collaboration between JMPM and the Rotterdam Convention on pesticide incident reporting.

An observer pointed out the potential value of a globally harmonized system, for example, a biomonitoring system of honeybees, as a proxy for pesticide hazard. A panel member responded to this suggestion, saying that national-level systems should be prioritized because it is more feasible and practicable. Furthermore, he questioned the veracity of self-reporting poisoning data by farmers, specifically in relation to identification of the product used, suggesting the need for a weight-of-evidence approach. Another panel member questioned farmers' perception of poisoning signs and symptoms in self-reported data.

A panel member emphasized the need to address the legal basis for incident reporting systems and the need for using the collected data to mitigate pesticide risks. Another panel member emphasized that the guidance should help LMICs with setting up systems by

starting small. Another panel member suggested that incidents due to public health pesticides and domestic pesticides should be captured in the guidance. It was further pointed out that reporting systems require collaboration between sectors, which can be a challenge.

As the next steps, the group agreed to develop an outline for the guidance document, to engage the Rotterdam Convention in the working group, and to request assistance in drafting the guidance document.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that the working group on the *Guidance on developing a reporting system for health and environmental incidents resulting from exposure to pesticides* develop an outline for the revision of the available guidelines (2009 edition) for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.
- that FAO/WHO contract a technical writer for drafting a revised version of the *Guidelines on developing a reporting system for health and environmental incidents resulting from exposure to pesticides* (2009 edition), based on the prepared outline, for review in the 19th JMPM meeting in 2026.

6.2 Guidance on management options for empty pesticide containers

Rorisang Mantutle (FAO panel member, Lesotho), as the Chairperson of the working group,[d] highlighted the problem of empty pesticide containers being re-used for storage of water or food or abandoned in the environment, causing hazards to health and to the environment. The 15th JMPM in 2022 had recommended a revision of the existing guidelines (2008 edition) to incorporate recent developments in empty container management. The revision could draw on the experiences from projects with a component on pesticide container management, and from CLI's stewardship programme.

Based on a preliminary gap analysis by FAO, the working group met in 2025 to consolidate the results of the gap analysis. The main gaps in the 2008 edition are:

- The legal framework section should be updated, especially to add compliance matrices and model clauses, recent examples of collection schemes, and criteria for container classification.
- The section on waste hierarchy and circular economy should be expanded by adding the circular economy lens, strengthening life cycle assessment of containers, and alignment with elements of policy and regulation.

[d] Working group composed of Jamal Hajjar, Rorisang Mantutle (Chairperson), Joseph Morrall, Mihaela Paun, Oxana Perminova, Andrew Ward, and a representative of WHO.

- The section on container design and materials should be updated by adding design guidelines, performance standards and life cycle assessment data, and by better reflecting the UN certification of containers.
- The section on cleaning and decontamination should be expanded on cleaning technology and include safety automation and International Organization for Standardization (ISO) references.
- The section on recycling and disposal technologies needs to add a decision tree, an annex on best available techniques (BAT) and best environmental practices (BEP) on new technologies and advanced recycling, and guidance on standards for recycled content.
- Guidance should be added on safe and responsible re-use of pesticide containers.
- The section on data and traceability should be updated by adding guidance on digital traceability and an open standard template, whilst data and traceability should be used as an evaluation tool by the industry to improve their collection programmes.
- The section on case studies should replace older cases with recent cases, and include lessons learned from CLI.
- The section on assessment of the scale of the issue should include glass containers and address the gap where recycling takes place without a control and monitoring mechanism.

In the ensuing discussion, a panel member highlighted the opportunity to learn from the experience with the first guideline, by finding out what worked and what did not. Another panel member suggested aligning the guidance with the Basel Convention. A panel member proposed that containers for public health pesticides and pesticides within the domestic domain should be covered in the guidance. Another panel member remarked that the focus should be on LMICs and that a traceability system should be made consistent with the market system.

WHO pointed out that large amounts of bulking materials and packaging of insecticide-treated nets (ITNs) are generated in public health programmes, and the nets themselves become waste after the end of their life (i.e. 3–4 years of use); it was queried whether this type of waste could be included in the guidance. A panel member commented that although ITNs are technically speaking not containers, their disposal requires urgent attention. An observer drew attention to the *FAO Voluntary Code of Conduct on the Sustainable Use and Management of Plastics in Agriculture* and the regulation on recycling in the European Union that will undergo major revision and suggested that the working group takes these matters into account. He gave examples of deposit return schemes and advanced recycling, which could possibly apply to used ITNs.

As the next steps, it was agreed that the working group develops a road map for the work, prepares the Terms of Reference for a consultant, and for FAO to hire a consultant.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that FAO/WHO request the working group on *Guidance on management options for empty pesticide containers* to finalize the scope and roadmap for the revision of the available guideline (2008 edition), based on the inputs received, for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.

- that FAO/WHO contract a technical writer for the drafting of a revised version of the *Guidelines on management options for empty pesticide containers* (2008 edition), based on the gap analysis and road map, for review in the 19th JMPM meeting in 2026.

7. Review of new guidance under development

7.1 Guidance note on application of pesticides by drones

In 2024, the JMPM agreed to develop a guidance note on pesticide application by drones. Archana Sinha (WHO panel member, India) as Chairperson of the working group[e] presented recent progress. The working group has had two meetings, with representation from several organizations working on drones, to prepare an outline for the guidance note, considering recent papers on drone application and spray drift. It was agreed that the guidance note should be brief, with a short section on spray drift, and written based on publicly available information. The working group should link with the OECD Drone Subgroup to ensure consistency and reduce duplication of efforts.

Archana Sinha pointed out that regulatory work to date has mostly focused on agriculture but that the use of drones in public health must be addressed. In public health programmes, drones could be used for both vector habitat surveillance and pesticide application, and for new technologies such as the release of sterile insects for disease control. The outline for the guidance note was presented, which included the scope, definition of drones, challenges, role of user groups, regulation and operation for agriculture and public health, exposure and risk assessment. The guidance note could draw on the available guidance on aerial application of pesticides.

Antony Wilson (Health and Safety Executive, United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland) presented the regulatory situation on using drones for plant protection in the United Kingdom. He explained the process of authorization of the use of drones for pesticide application, which is still under review. Work is underway to generate data in support of risk assessment. He emphasized that drones have the potential to improve worker safety in pesticide application. Work is ongoing internationally to understand how data can be used to support commercial authorizations.

Huizhu Yuan (AgroCare, China) presented the development of pesticide application for plant protection by drones in China. The number of drones for pesticide application in China increased rapidly over the past few years, driven by labour shortage, technological development and government support. Adjuvants are tested to enhance the efficacy of drone-based applications and reduce drift. Pesticide application by drones in China is regulated by legislation, specifications and guidelines.

In the discussion, one panel member proposed adding the topic of certification to the outline. A panel member cautioned that the size of each section should be kept small, considering the small size of a guidance note. The type of formulation, the use of adjuvants to change droplet size, and labelling could be captured but require further discussion. UNEP proposed to capture in the outline the role of environmental authorities, and environmental

[e] Working group composed of Jamal Hajjar, Eliana Munarriz, Nosiku Munyinda, Mengmeng Qu, Archana Sinha (Chairperson), Greg Watson, Anthony Wilson, Kris Wyckhuys, and representatives of FAO, UNEP and WHO.

impacts due to drift, thus linking to the guidance on pesticide incidents. Another participant highlighted the aspect of bystander exposure; however, it was noted that available data on bystander exposure are not in the public domain.

A panel member queried whether independent scientific studies regarding risks associated with pesticide application by drones have been published; majority of data comes from industry; with some data on spray drift appearing in peer-reviewed journals.

A panel member mentioned that in China, research and development have been far ahead of regulatory decision-making, even though the data requirements on drone application are being updated. It was pointed out that several companies in India, China and several African countries are working on drone applications for vector control in public health, emphasizing the need to engage the health sector in regulatory efforts. In China it is expected that large drones will be developed for broadcasting fertilizer and seeds.

An observer suggested separating chemical pesticides and biopesticides in the guidance note, comparing their risk profiles, and with less stringent regulation for biopesticides. A panel member remarked that the choice of the type of pesticide is outside the scope of the guidance note. The group highlighted the need to expedite the development of the guidance note and to also plan a full guidance document in due course. Drones are expected to revolutionize pesticide application and risk management, and the guidance note should address different types of risks as well as social and economic benefits, good regulatory measures, certification of operators, and use for agriculture and public health.

As the next steps, the outline will be updated for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026, after which a consultant could be hired to help drafting the note.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that the working group on *Guidance note on application of pesticides by drones* prepares an updated outline for the development of a guidance note, based on the inputs received, and circulates it for approval by the JMPM members by 30th November 2025.
- that FAO/WHO contract a technical writer for drafting a *Guidance note on application of pesticides by drones* based on the updated outline, for presentation at the 19th JMPM meeting in 2026.

7.2 Guidance note on registration of minor use pesticides

Shumirayi Muhera provided an overview of the developments regarding the registration of minor use pesticides, reminding the group that Anna Gore (Minor Use Foundation) had presented the subject at the 17th JMPM in 2024. The issue is that farmers of minor use crops have limited access to pest management tools due to a lack of pesticide registrations for these crops. Pesticide registrars from several countries have requested help in this regard. In response, the 17th JMPM recommended that FAO propose the way forward for developing

guidance on registration of minor use pesticides. In both JMPM intersessional meetings in 2025, Anna Gore proposed an outline to the panel members.

In her presentation, Anna Gore proposed that the guidance should refer to, and make accessible, available guidance, such as the pesticide registration toolkit and other relevant guidance by FAO and OECD. She also proposed that the guidance would include case studies to help regulators make decisions using the available guidance documents. She then presented her outline, which included definitions, challenges, successes, and ways to address the challenges using case studies.

During the 18th JMPM meeting, a working group was established, with Eliana Munarriz (WHO panel member, Argentina) as Chairperson.[f] It was emphasized that the guidance will be developed by JMPM, and that the outline by the Minor Use Foundation will serve as an information document. The guidance note should optimize practical usability by registrars, with references to available guidance, and aim to reduce off-label use of conventional pesticides (e.g. through label expansion) in LMICs.

During the discussion, a panel member questioned the definition of minor use crops and questioned whether the scope and size of the work would develop beyond that of a guidance note, as was recommended. Another panel member questioned what minor use pesticides constitute, whether they are for specific pests or for specific uses.

A panel member asked about the difference in data requirements of major use versus minor use pesticides, considering that the market for minor use is small. UNEP noted that minor use pesticides may be small in scale, but they can cause localized pollution or biodiversity loss if oversight is weak. Also, environmental incidents from the use of minor use pesticides could be linked to the guidance on pesticide incidents.

As the next steps, a rationale on positioning the guidance note will be developed by the working group, after which an outline will be developed.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that the working group on *Guidance on registration of minor use pesticides* develops an outline for a guidance note, based on the inputs received, for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.

7.3 Glossary of terms and definitions on pesticide management

The Glossary of terms and definitions on pesticide management is being finalized.[g] Its publication has been put on hold because it should be published only after publication of the *Guidance on data requirements for pesticide registration* to which it refers.

---

[f] Working group composed of Anna Gore, Jamal Hajjar, Rorisang Mantutle, Shumirayi Muhera, Eliana Munarriz (Chairperson), Archana Sinha, Andrew Ward, Wang Yue, and people representing OECD and UNEP.

[g] Working group composed of Joseph Morrall, Shumirayi Muhera, Andi Trisyono, and Sheila Willis.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that FAO/WHO publish the *Glossary of terms and definitions on pesticide management* after the *Guidance on data requirements for pesticide registration* has been published.

8. Emerging and priority issues in pesticide management and planning the development of new guidance

8.1 Prioritization of emerging issues

A discussion session was held to list and prioritize the issues previously recommended by the JMPM for the development of guidance, with the aim to prioritize the issues, to identify the members of each working group and to manage the next steps, considering the limitation with the available resources.

The JMPM Secretariat emphasised the focus of work should be on the guidance documents currently under revision or development.

The 18th JMPM agreed on the following matters:

Items that have been completed:

- The *WHO aircraft disinfection methods and procedures* (published, but not yet circulated).

Items currently under development:

- Revision of the Code of Conduct (see Section 5).
- *Guidance on developing a reporting system for health and environmental incidents resulting from exposure to pesticides* (see Section 6.1).
- *Guidance on management options for empty pesticide containers* (see Section 6.2)
- *Guidance note on application of pesticides by drones* (see Section 7.1)
- *Guidance note on registration of minor use pesticides* (see Section 7.2)
- *Glossary of terms and definitions on pesticide management* (awaiting publication; see Section 7.3)

Items that were added in the 18th JMPM meeting as priorities for new guidance:

- *Guidance on risk communication on pesticides* (see Section 8.2)
- *Guidance on monitoring and management of pesticide resistance* (see Section 8.3)

In addition, it was decided that JMPM will address the following miscellaneous issues:

- Request regarding *Decision RC-12/5 on enhancing the effectiveness of the Rotterdam Convention* (Criterion 6 of HHPs) (see Section 10.1)
- Toolkit on risk evaluation methodology for the Rotterdam Convention (see Section 10.2)

Items that were not prioritized by the 18th JMPM and were put on hold:

- Revision of *Guidelines on post-registration surveillance and other activities in the field of pesticides* (1988 edition).
- Nano-pesticides and other emerging pesticide technologies (e.g. RNAi-based pesticides).
- Gender mainstreaming in JMPM guidance.
- Responsible use of artificial intelligence (AI) powered decision-support tools for pesticide management.

8.2 Guidance on risk communication on pesticides

The JMPM first recommended the development of guidance on risk communication in its 15th meeting in 2022. The subject was discussed again in the 16th and 17th JMPM in 2023 and 2024 respectively, and a provisional working group was formed at the time. However, due to other priorities of the JMPM, this subject was put on hold.

In the 18th JMPM meeting in 2025, risk communication on pesticides was prioritized for the development of new guidance. New members were added to the working group, with Helena Casabona (FAO panel member, Sweden) as Chairperson.[h] No substantive discussion was held on the subject. The group agreed to develop an outline for discussion in the next intersessional meeting, based on previous inputs, and consider if there is a need to contract a technical writer for drafting.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that the working group on *Guidance on risk communication on pesticides* develops an outline for a guidance document for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.

8.3 Guidance on monitoring and management of pesticide resistance

The 17th JMPM had recommended that the *FAO Guidelines on Prevention and Management of Pesticide Resistance* (2012 edition) should be revisited. In the 18th JMPM, this matter was discussed further. A working group, with Jamal Hajjar (FAO panel member, Saudi Arabia) as Chairperson, was formed during the meeting.[i]

In the discussion, it was noted that apart from the 2012 guidelines, other relevant documents are available or under revision on pesticide resistance. CLI has established resistance action committees on four groups of pesticides. The European and Mediterranean Plant Protection

[h] Working group composed of Helena Casabona (Chairperson), Eliana Munarriz, Nosiku Munyinda, Andrew Ward, Sheila Willis, and Kris Wyckhuys.

[i] Working group composed of Jamal Hajjar (Chairperson), Seth Irish, Shumirayi Muhera, Nosiku Munyinda, Archana Sinha, Andi Trisyono, Mengmeng Qu, and a person representing CLI.

Organization (EPPO) is developing a document on best practices in resistance monitoring. Moreover, WHO is planning to update its *Global plan for insecticide resistance management in malaria vectors* (2012 edition), which will include vectors of several diseases, and WHO plans to update its manual for resistance monitoring to include new insecticides. These documents would be useful resources for the JMPM working group.

There was a lengthy discussion about the scope of the guidance, should it focus on agricultural pests or include public health vectors and pests, and whether it should concentrate on the monitoring or management of resistance or both. The meeting agreed that there is a challenge in combining different sectors in one document, farmer-level for agriculture versus the national-programme level for public health. WHO highlighted the opportunity to develop a harmonized approach across sectors, that would address cross-cutting issues such as the role of agricultural pesticide use in resistance development of disease vectors. WHO further emphasized the need to align resistance management with integrated vector management (IVM) and IPM.

The JMPM agreed that the scope should be kept broad within working group discussions allowing the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026 to make final decisions on the guidance.

As the next steps, the working group will prepare an outline for the guidance and propose the Terms of Reference for a consultant to assist with the work.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that the working group on *Guidance on monitoring and management of pesticide resistance* develops an outline for a guidance document for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.

9. Operation of the Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management

9.1 Terms of Reference of the JMPM

The 17th JMPM made several recommendations regarding the Terms of Reference of the JMPM to describe the participation of observers and the process of inclusion of pesticide user organizations and other stakeholders in the supply chain, and to clarify the modality of work in working groups and meetings.

Rajpal Yadav (FAO consultant) presented the initial draft of the *Terms of reference for the FAO/UNP/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management (JMPM)* incorporating previous feedback from panel members. The document described the composition, selection and functions of the panels, addressing responsibilities and conflicts of interests. The document further described the role of consultants, observers, other stakeholders, the Chairperson, and the Secretariat, and described the procedure of meetings, amongst others.

The meeting discussed the document, paragraph by paragraph. Apart from minor edits, there was discussion about the representation of panel members, who nominally participate in their personal capacity. A clause was added that where panel members are obliged by the nature of their employment to represent the position in government or their institution, this will be noted at the start of each JMPM in a conflict-of-interest declaration by the panel member. Further discussion centred around the participation of observers in JMPM meetings. Additional modifications were made regarding the quorum for JMPM meetings, and the process of making recommendations by the JMPM, including consensus-building for decisions.

The final modifications were made and presented to the JMPM on the last day of the 17th JPMP meeting, and the panel endorsed the document.

9.2 Standard operating procedure for the development of guidance

The 17th JMPM recommended that FAO and WHO develop a formal standardized process for developing JMPM documents, clarifying the roles of JMPM panel members, external consultants, observers, and FAO and WHO contributors in their participation in the drafting groups.

Rajpal Yadav (FAO consultant) presented the initial draft of the *Standard operating procedure (SOP) for the development of FAO/UNEP/WHO guidance on pesticide management*. The draft incorporated previous feedback from panel members from three earlier iterations.

The meeting discussed the document, paragraph by paragraph, and made final modifications. Redundant paragraphs were removed and minor editorial changes were made. More substantive discussions centred around the process of approval and endorsement of

guidance documents, and the types of guidance outputs of the JMPM, agreeing that the JMPM's role is advisory, not advocacy.

After the modifications were included in the document, a clean version was presented to the JMPM on the last day of the meeting. The panel endorsed the final document.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that the JMPM Secretariat circulates the finalized *Standard operating procedure for the development of guidance on pesticide management* and the *Terms of Reference for the JMPM* to the JMPM panel members.

9.3 Action Plan for the Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management

The JMPM Secretariat has kept previous JMPM Action Plans as a living document. The current Action Plan should be added to that document.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that FAO/WHO update the JMPM Action Plan with clear timelines, responsibilities, and prioritization, within 30 days of JMPM annual and intersessional meetings, whilst actions that have been completed or paused could be archived and kept in the record history.

10. Other issues

10.1 Request regarding Decision of the Rotterdam Convention (RC)-12/5

Friederike Breuer explained the request made to the JMPM by the Rotterdam Convention at its 12th COP in 2025. The formal request stated: Regarding Decision RC-12/5 on enhancing the effectiveness of the Rotterdam Convention, item 5, the COP "*kindly invites* the Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management (JMPM) of the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations and the World Health Organization to discuss, as appropriate, the use of Annex III as a criterion for defining Highly Hazardous Pesticides (HHPs) under Criterion 6 of the Guidelines on Highly Hazardous Pesticides of the International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management."[j]

The COP meeting report (paragraphs 156 and 157) elaborates on the issue of concern. Brazil reported obstacles to listing substances recommended for listing and proposed that FAO and WHO revise their "listing in Annex III" as a criterion for HHPs. Characterizing those chemicals that are included in Annex III automatically as HHPs has had unintended consequences. For example, private certification schemes have used the listing in Annex III to justify bans of chemicals, which has resulted in confusion among Parties.

Yvonne Ewang-Sanvincenti (Legal Officer, Secretariat of the Basel, Rotterdam and Stockholm Conventions) clarified that the Rotterdam Convention allows countries to decide if they wish to engage in international trade or not. The listing in Annex III is for information-sharing and does not equate a global ban but apparently, the listing has erroneously been used as a definition of HHPs and as a justification for a ban.

FAO reiterated that the purpose of JMPM guidance is to raise awareness about negative impacts of pesticides including HHPs and to help countries mitigate the risks. The JMPM should assess the issue and advise on the way forward, with justifications, bearing in mind that removal of criterion 6 may have consequences for some other criteria of HHPs. WHO expressed concern that HHPs are still used for vector control; the WHO's prequalification team does not preclude HHPs if they are submitted for evaluation.

In the ensuing discussion, the initial views of the participants were collected. A panel member remarked that removal of criteria may create the need for new criteria, for example, on severely hazardous pesticide formulations. Another panel member reminded that the request from the Rotterdam Convention is restricted to criterion 6 only, which should give the JMPM a limited scope in their response. Another panel member mentioned that when a country lists

[j] The FAO/WHO *Guidelines on Highly Hazardous Pesticides* (2016 edition) have defined HHPs as having one or more of 8 criteria listed in the document. Criterion 6 is "Pesticide active ingredients and formulations listed by the Rotterdam Convention in its Annex III". Annex III of the *Rotterdam Convention* contains a list of chemicals that have been banned or severely restricted for health or environmental reasons by two or more Parties and which the COP has decided to subject to the Prior Informed Consent (PIC) procedure. The current list contains 36 pesticides, 3 of which are severely hazardous pesticide formulations.

a chemical in Annex III, it is upon that country what to do with that chemical, but she cautioned that removing criterion 6 could increase the risk for LMICs.

A panel member added that, given that the purpose of Annex III is the exchange of information, not imposing a ban, he supported the removal of criterion 6. A panel member mentioned that the purpose of the guidance is to help countries decide how to treat HHPs, not necessarily through a ban, and perhaps further explanation is needed on how to use the guidance. A panel member suggested that the deletion of criterion 6 could support an increase in listings in Annex III. A panel member highlighted the opportunity to make a decision that can have positive impacts for countries.

An observer questioned whether the JMPM in its discussions is overstepping the mandate given by the Rotterdam Convention, and she further expressed concern with confusion in definitions on HHPs, as the 2016 definition has been adopted in the GFC, and emphasized that banning a HHP is a national-level decision. An observer further noted that the deletion of criterion 6 might affect the trust in the JMPM.

FAO added that a response by the JMPM should be evidence based. The JMPM agreed to take more time to think about the most appropriate response to the Rotterdam Convention and its possible implications for countries.

As the next steps, the JMPM will continue the discussion with a separate agenda item in a meeting in 2026 and prepare a response in time of the next COP in 2027.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that the JMPM Secretariat respond to the Secretariat of the Rotterdam Convention, acknowledging their request regarding Decision RC-12/5 on the use of Annex III as a criterion for defining Highly Hazardous Pesticides and informing that the JMPM continues the discussion on this subject.

10.2 Toolkit on risk evaluation methodology for the Rotterdam Convention

In response to another request made by the Rotterdam Convention in 2022, the 15th JMPM had recommended the development of a toolkit or guidance to support countries in developing risk evaluation methodology. However, this recommendation was put on hold.

In the 18th JMPM in 2025, it was agreed to address this outstanding recommendation. In the discussion, a panel member asked whether guidance already exists regarding risk management methodology. The Rotterdam Convention Secretariat updated the group that a regulatory action evaluation toolkit has recently become available from the Rotterdam Convention to support countries in doing a risk evaluation. In addition, FAO indicated that its *Pesticide Registration Toolkit* includes modules on risk assessment. Taking these resources into account, the group agreed to review the available toolkits, starting with the one from the Rotterdam Convention, and then linking it to FAO's *Pesticide Registration Toolkit*, to decide

on whether more work will be needed. Joseph Morrall volunteered to review the available materials and to put together a summary for discussion in the next intersessional meeting.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that a briefing paper on developing risk evaluation methodology under the Rotterdam Convention be presented in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.

10.3 Communication strategy

Anecdotal information suggests that the JMPM documents are not optimally accessed or used by the intended audience. Throughout the meeting, the group emphasized the importance of the wide dissemination of guidance produced by the JMPM. Moreover, there is an urgent need to study adoption rates and to obtain feedback and input from end users to assist the JMPM in adjusting their documents according to the need and demand.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that FAO/WHO prepare an outline for a communication strategy for wider dissemination of JMPM guidance documents, including the use of existing fora and networks to present guidance to stakeholders for their inputs and feedback for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.

10.4 Coordination with the Joint Meeting on Pesticide Residues and the Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management

The JMPM has to date not interacted with the JMPR and the JMPS. Together, these three panels influence the specifications, residues and management of pesticides at the global level. A panel member proposed that interaction between these three panels should be established to improve coordination on specific and unseen issues. For example, interaction could improve referencing of public health and domestic pesticides to address the risks of pesticide exposures in the domestic environment.

The 18th JMPM recommended:

- that the JMPM Secretariat facilitates coordination between the JMPM, JMPR and JMPS, as appropriate.

10.5 Miscellaneous issues

WHO pointed out that the last *Global survey on pesticide registration and management practices* was conducted in 2017, and that, if appropriate, a plan could be made for a follow-up survey in 1–2 years to update the situation. The results of the survey will provide important feedback on the priorities in pesticide management as a resource for the work of the JMPM.

11. Recommendations

The formal recommendations from the 18th FAO/WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management (JMPM), held from 7–10 October 2025 at WHO headquarters in Geneva, Switzerland, are presented below.

Revision of the Code of Conduct

The 18th JMPM recommends:

- that the JMPM Secretariat release the endorsed JMPM *Report of Reviewing the International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management (ICCPM) regarding the free, prior and informed consent (FPIC) of Indigenous Peoples* for consultation.
- that the FAO/WHO task force collate and provide to the JMPM the responses from the consultation regarding the JMPM *Report of Reviewing the International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management (ICCPM) regarding the free, prior and informed consent (FPIC) of Indigenous Peoples*.

Reporting systems for health and environmental incidents

The 18th JMPM recommends:

- that the working group on *Guidance on developing a reporting system for health and environmental incidents resulting from exposure to pesticides* develop an outline for the revision of the available guidelines (2009 edition) for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.
- that FAO/WHO contract a technical writer for drafting a revised version of the *Guideline on developing a reporting system for health and environmental incidents resulting from exposure to pesticides* (2009 edition), based on the prepared outline, for review in the 19th JMPM meeting in 2026.

Management options for empty pesticide containers

The 18th JMPM recommends:

- that FAO/WHO request the working group on *Guidance on management options for empty pesticide containers* to finalize the scope and roadmap for the revision of the available guideline (2008 edition), based on the inputs received, for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.
- that FAO/WHO contract a technical writer for the drafting of a revised version of the *Guidelines on management options for empty pesticide containers* (2008 edition), based on the gap analysis and road map, for review in the 19th JMPM meeting in 2026.

Application of pesticides by drones

The 18th JMPM recommends:

- that the working group on *Guidance note on application of pesticides by drones* prepares an updated outline for the development of a guidance note, based on the inputs received, and circulates it for approval by the JMPM members by 30th November 2025.
- that FAO/WHO contract a technical writer for drafting a *Guidance note on application of pesticides by drones* based on the updated outline, for presentation in the 19th JMPM meeting in 2026.

Registration of minor use pesticides

The 18th JMPM recommends:

- that the working group on *Guidance note on registration of minor use pesticides* develops an outline for a guidance note on the registration of minor use pesticides, based on the inputs received, for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.

Risk communication

The 18th JMPM recommends:

- that the working group on *Guidance on risk communication on pesticides* develops an outline for a guidance document for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.

Pesticide resistance

The 18th JMPM recommends:

- that the working group on *Guidance on monitoring and management of pesticide resistance* develops an outline for a guidance document for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.

Glossary of terms and definitions

The 18th JMPM recommends:

- that FAO/WHO publish the *Glossary of terms and definitions on pesticide management* after the *Guidance on data requirements for pesticide registration* has been published.

Operation of JMPM

The 18th JMPM recommends:

- that the JMPM Secretariat circulates the finalized *Standard operating procedure for the development of guidance on pesticide management* and the *Terms of Reference for the JMPM* to the JMPM panel members.

Other issues

The 18th JMPM recommends:

- that the JMPM Secretariat respond to the Secretariat of the Rotterdam Convention, acknowledging their request regarding *Decision RC-12/5* on the use of Annex III as a criterion for defining Highly Hazardous Pesticides and informing that the JMPM continues the discussion on this subject.
- that a briefing paper on developing risk evaluation methodology under the Rotterdam Convention be presented in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.
- that the JMPM Secretariat facilitate coordination between the JMPM, JMPR and JMPS, as appropriate.
- that FAO/WHO prepare an outline for a communication strategy for wider dissemination of JMPM guidance documents, including the use of existing fora and networks to present guidance to stakeholders for their inputs and feedback for discussion in the first JMPM intersessional meeting in 2026.
- that FAO/WHO update the JMPM Action Plan with clear timelines, responsibilities, and prioritization, within 30 days of JMPM annual and intersessional meetings, whilst actions that have been completed or paused could be archived and kept in the record history.

12. Closing

Baogen Gu announced that the 19th meeting of the JMPM will be hosted by FAO and will provisionally be held from 12–16 October 2026 at the FAO headquarters in Rome or any other suitable venue (unless UNEP offers to host the 19th JMPM meeting in the case where it joins the JMPM Secretariat soon). The JMPM further agreed to convene the next JMPM intersessional meeting on a convenient day in the week of 13 April 2026.

Baogen Gu recapped the outcomes of the meeting, which included endorsement of the *Report on reviewing the International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management regarding FPIC for Indigenous Peoples*, the JMPM *SOP on developing guidance and Terms of reference for the JMPM*, progress towards developing the outlines for four new guidance documents, and emerging issues. Most importantly, valuable recommendations have been made, which will be followed up by the JMPM Secretariat. Baogen Gu stated that the meeting had been very efficient and productive due to good preparations by all involved, fruitful discussions, and proficient moderation. He thanked Nosiku Munyinda and Helena Casabona for chairing the meeting.

Noting that Raman Velayudhan will retire from WHO in March 2026, the JMPM expressed their appreciation for his professional guidance and strong leadership over the past years. Moreover, Baogen Gu thanked Andre Peralta (FAO panel member, Brazil), at the end of his term as FAO panel member, for his dedication and support to the JMPM.

Raman Velayudhan thanked the Chairperson, co-Chairperson and Rapporteurs, and other participants for a productive meeting. Regarding his upcoming retirement, he mentioned that Maru Aregawi Weldedawit and Emmanuel Chanda will be taking over the JMPM WHO Secretariat. He thanked the WHO staff for their excellent secretarial support. Concluding, Maru Aregawi Weldedawit summarized his observations during the meeting and noted its successful conduct, after which he closed the meeting.

Annex 1. Adopted agenda

18TH FAO/WHO JOINT MEETING ON PESTICIDE MANAGEMENT
6 – 10 October 2025
Venue: WHO, headquarters
Geneva, Switzerland
D building, 4th floor, room D46025

Monday, 6 October 2025	
Pre-Meeting of the FAO and WHO JMPM Secretariat and Chairperson and co-Chairperson (at WHO headquarters)	14:00–16:00

Tuesday, 7 October 2025	
<u>Closed session</u> **i. Panel working procedures and programme of work** – Membership (new Panel member) – Chairperson, co-Chairperson and Rapporteurs – Any other matters	09:30–10:00
<u>Open session</u> **1. Welcome and opening remarks** **– Welcome remarks (WHO)** **– Introduction of participants** **– Opening remarks** **○ WHO** **○ FAO** **2. Declaration of interest** **3. Appointment of Chairperson, co-Chairperson and Rapporteurs** **4. Adoption of agenda** **5. Meeting procedure, working arrangements and housekeeping matters**	10:00–10:30
Morning tea/coffee break	10:30–10:45
6. Summary of developments and action taken after the 17th JMPM in 2024 **Brief reports (10' max for each) on progress on pesticide management and initiatives by WHO, FAO, UNEP, OECD, PAN, IPEN, CLI, IBMA and AgroCare**	10:45–12:30
Lunch break	12:30–14:00
7. Review of actions taken on the Recommendations of the 17th JMPM meeting **Report progress of "Follow-up Action Plan"**	14:00–14:15
8. Presentation and discussion on draft Report of reviewing the International Code of Conduct (Joseph and JMPM WG, Task Force, and JMPM Secretariat)	14:15–15:30
Afternoon tea/coffee break	15:30–15:45
Discussion on the draft Report of reviewing the Code of Conduct (cont.)	15:45–17:30

Wednesday, 8 October 2025	
9. Review of new guidance documents under development	
a) Guidance on developing a reporting system for health and environmental incidents resulting from exposure to pesticides **b) Revision of Guidelines on management options for empty pesticide containers**	09:00–10:45
Morning tea/coffee break	10:45–11:00
c) Guidance note on application of pesticides by drones	11:00–12:30
Lunch break	12:30–14:00
d) Guidance on registration of minor use pesticides	14:00–15:30
Afternoon tea/coffee break	15:30–15:45
e) Standard Operating Procedure for the development of guidance on pesticide management	15:45–17:30
Note: Rapporteurs to work on recommendations	17:3–19:30 (flexible)
Reception hosted by WHO at WHO headquarters main cafeteria	18:00

Thursday, 9 October 2015	
10. Review of the JMPM Terms of Reference **11. Decision of the 2025 BRS COPs regarding the use of Annex III of Rotterdam Convention for criterion 6 of the Guideline on HHPs**	09:00–10:45
Morning tea/coffee break	10:45–11:00
12. Emerging and priority issues in pesticide management, including gaps, challenges and future directions of FAO, WHO and UNEP **13. Planning development of new guidelines and review of existing guidelines** **14. Any other issues**	11:00–12:30
Lunch break	12:30–14:00
<u>Closed session</u> **(only Secretariat and JMPM Panel Members)** **15. Drafting of the JMPM Recommendations**	14:00–15:30

Thursday, 9 October 2015 (cont.)	
Afternoon tea/coffee break	15:30–15:45
16. Reviewing and finalizing the JMPM Recommendations (cont.)	15:45–17:00
Note: Rapporteurs to finalize the JMPM recommendations	17:00–19:00 (flexible)
Dinner in Geneva (contributory)	19:00

Friday, 10 October 2025	
Closed session **17. Reviewing and finalizing the JMPM Recommendations (cont.)**	9:00–10:30
Morning tea/ coffee break	10:30–11:00
Open session **18. Presentation of the JMPM Recommendations** **19. Dates and place of the 19th JMPM meeting in 2026**	11:00–12:15
Closing	12:15–12:30

Annex 2. List of participants

FAO panel members

Helena Casabona, Strategic Adviser, Department of Development of Legislation & Other Instruments, International Unit, Swedish Chemicals Agency, Sundbyberg, Sweden.

Mohammed Jamal Hajjar, Professor of Pesticides Science and Toxicology, College of Agriculture and Food Sciences, King Faisal University, Hufof, Saudi Arabia.

Rorisang Mantutle, Chief Crop Production Officer, Ministry of Agriculture and Food Security, Government of Lesotho, Maseru, Lesotho.

Ashley Nelsen, Senior Trade Advisor, United States Environmental Protection Agency, Office of Chemical Safety and Pollution Prevention, Office of Program Support, Intergovernmental Community Relations Branch, Washington DC, United States of America (online).

Andre Carrapatoso Peralta, Agricultural Inspector, Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock and Food Supply, Brasília, Brazil.

Mengmeng Qu, Director, Toxicology Division, Institute for the Control of Agrochemicals, Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Affairs, Beijing, China.

Andi Trisyono, Professor, Department of Plant Protection, Faculty of Agriculture, Universitas Gadjah Mada, Yogyakarta, Indonesia.

WHO panel members

Joseph Paul Leslie Morrall, Director International Policy, Foresty and Agvet Chemicals, Department of Agriculture, Water and the Environment, Australian Government, Canberra, Australia.

Eliana Rosa Munarriz, Group Leader, Agricultural and Environmental Biosciences Research Institute, National Research Council, Buenos Aires, Argentina.

Nosiku Sipilanyambe Munyinda, Lecturer, School of Public Health, Department of Environmental Health, Pollution Control and Toxicology Unit, University of Zambia, Lusaka, Zambia.

Archana Sinha, Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, Government of India, New Delhi, India (online).

Intergovernmental organizations

United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)

Mihaela Claudia Paun, Officer-in-Charge, Head of Knowledge and Risk Unit, Chemicals and Health Branch, Industry and Economy Division, Geneva, Switzerland.

Anitha Koyra, Associate Programme Management Officer, Knowledge and Risk Unit, Chemicals and Health Branch, Industry and Economy Division, Geneva, Switzerland.

Adelaide Gartili, Intern, Knowledge and Risk Unit, Chemicals and Health Branch, Industry and Economy Division, Geneva, Switzerland.

Secretariat of the Basel, Rotterdam and Stockholm Conventions

Yvonne Ewang-Sanvincenti, Legal Officer, Governance Branch, Geneva, Switzerland.

Lina Fortelius, Programme Management Officer, Geneva, Switzerland.

Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)

Sarah de Marcellus, Administrator, Pesticides and Biotechnology, Food and Feed Safety Programmes, Environment, Health and Safety Division, Environment Directorate, OECD, Paris, France (online).

Jane Richardson, Principal Administrator, Pesticides and Biotechnology, Food and Feed Safety Programmes, Environment, Health and Safety Division, Environment Directorate, OECD, Paris, France (online).

Observers

CropLife International (CLI)

Andrew Ward, Director Stewardship, CLI, Brussels, Belgium.

International Biocontrol Manufacturers Association (IBMA)

Jennifer Lewis, Executive Director, IBMA, Brussels, Belgium (online).

AgroCare

Yuan Huizhu, China Crop Protection Industry Association, Beijing, China.

Wang Yue, China Crop Protection Industry Association, Beijing, China (online).

Pesticide Action Network

Sheila Willis, Pesticide Action Network UK, Brighton, United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland (online).

International Pollutants Elimination Network (IPEN), Pesticides Working Group

Tadesse Amera, Executive Director of Pesticide Action Network (Ethiopia), IPEN, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia.

International Indian Treaty Council (IITC)

Andrea Carmen, Executive Director, International Indian Treaty Council, Arizona, United States of America.

Special topics

Applications of pesticides by drones

Anthony Wilson, Senior Regulatory Scientist, Health and Safety Executive, York, United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland (online).

Minor use pesticides

Anna Gore, Executive Director, Minor Use Foundation, Raleigh, NC, United States of America (online).

WHO representation

WHO headquarters (JMPM Secretariat)

Faiza Abdirahman, Technical Officer, Veterinary Public Health, Vector Control and Environment Unit, Department of Control of Neglected Tropical Diseases, Geneva, Switzerland (online).

Piumee Bandara, Consultant, Department of Mental Health and Substance Use, Geneva, Switzerland.

Richard Brown, Technical Officer, Chemicals, Radiation and Health Unit**,** Department of Environment, Climate Change and Health, Geneva, Switzerland.

Emmanuel Chanda, Technical Lead (Vector Control), Vector, Disease Control, Elimination and Eradication across sectors Unit, Malaria and Neglected Tropical Diseases Department, Geneva, Switzerland.

Alexandra Fleischmann, Scientist, Department of Mental Health and Substance Use, Geneva, Switzerland.

Seth Irish, Technical Officer, Integrated Vector Management and Pesticide Stewardship, Vector, Disease Control, Elimination and Eradication across sectors Unit, Malaria and Neglected Tropical Diseases Department, Geneva, Switzerland.

Pauliina Nykanen-Rettaroli, Unit Head, Gender, Equity and Human Rights team, Geneva, Switzerland (online).

Henk van den Berg, Consultant (report writer), Visiting Scientist, Laboratory of Entomology, Wageningen University, Wageningen, Kingdom of the Netherlands.

Raman Velayudhan, Coordinator, Veterinary Public Health, Vector Control and Environment Unit, Malaria and Neglected Tropical Diseases Department, Geneva, Switzerland.

Maru Aregawi Weldedawit, Head, Vectors, Disease Control, Elimination and Eradication across sectors Unit, Malaria and Neglected Tropical Diseases Department, Geneva, Switzerland.

Rajpal Yadav, WHO Temporary Adviser, Gurugram, Haryana, India.

FAO representation

FAO headquarters (JMPM Secretariat)

Gu Baogen, Senior Agricultural Officer, Pest and Pesticide Management, Plant Production and Protection Division, Rome, Italy.

Shumirayi Muhera, Pest and Pesticide Management, Plant Production and Protection Division, Rome, Italy.

Friederike Breuer, Associate Professional Officer, Rotterdam Convention (NSPRD), Plant Production and Protection Division, Rome, Italy (online).

Susana Lidia Reyes Gomez, Indigenous Peoples Unit, Partnerships and UN Collaboration Division, Rome, Italy (online).

Yon Fernandez de Larrinoa, Head, Indigenous Peoples Unit, Partnerships and UN Collaboration Division, Rome, Italy (online).

Valeria Pasarin Linares, Right to Food Specialist, Inclusive Rural Transformation and Gender Equality Division, Rome, Italy (online).

Oxana Perminova, Agricultural Officer, Pest and Pesticide Management, Plant Production and Protection Division, Rome, Italy (online).

Guibiao Ye, Agricultural Officer, Pest and Pesticide Management, Plant Production and Protection Division, Rome, Italy (online).

Margret Vidar, Legal Officer, Development Law Service, Legal Office, Rome, Italy (online).

Kris Andre Wyckhuys, Integrated Pest Management Specialist, Pest and Pesticide Management, Plant Production and Protection Division, Rome, Italy (online).

Pablo Innecken Zuniga, Advocacy Officer, Partnerships and UN Collaboration Division, Rome, Italy (online).

Annex 3. Report of Reviewing the International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management regarding the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples

FAO and WHO Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management
10 October 2025

Table of Contents

Executive Summary 41
Introduction 42
FPIC WG Operational Premise 43
FPIC WG Operating Framework 43
Concurrent Context 44
Considerations 44
Operational stages 47
Considered Information 48
Findings and recommendations 47
Additional points 47

Executive Summary

1. In October 2024, COAG 29 requested the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO), in collaboration with the World Health Organization (WHO) to conduct a review of the *International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management* (ICCPM) for potential gaps related to the free, prior and informed consent (FPIC) of Indigenous Peoples.[1] The JMPM hereby submits its response to the request.

2. In response, the JMPM established a Working Group (WG) to consider if gaps within the ICCPM fail to consider the FPIC of Indigenous Peoples. The WG was comprised of selected JMPM panellists.[k] FAO and WHO also established a Taskforce to support the WG in gathering information and evidence. This included conducting an analysis of international frameworks, treaties and obligations, and undertaking a questionnaire on the experiences of Indigenous Peoples with pesticide management and FPIC. The Taskforce was comprised of the JMPM Secretariat along with representatives of legal and Indigenous Peoples units from both FAO and WHO.

3. To conduct the review, the WG compared the articles, submissions, survey results and international legal frameworks and obligations to identify, as follows:

   3.1. Potential gaps, such as the lack of processes to respect the FPIC of Indigenous Peoples, that are hindering the operation of the sound practices within the guidance of the ICCPM.

[k] JMPM working group members are Helena Casabona, Jamal Hajjar, Rorisang Mantutle, Joseph Morrall (Chairperson), Nosiku Munyinda, Ashley Nelsen, and Andre Peralta.

3.2. Possible harmful impacts to Indigenous Peoples where pesticide use is in accordance with the ICCPM.

4. The Taskforce, established by FAO and WHO, analysed various existing international frameworks, treaties, and obligations for previously available guidance and recommendations. The Taskforce also conducted a global questionnaire designed specifically for Indigenous Peoples. The goal of the questionnaire was to gather their perspectives, experiences, and concerns related to pesticide use and management, and to ensure that Indigenous Peoples' right to FPIC is fully respected.

5. The WG highlights that:

   5.1. The ICCPM, and sound practices detailed within it, as well as its supporting materials and guidance, apply equally to all peoples, including Indigenous Peoples.

   5.2. In considering the harms from pesticide use or activities reported to the JMPM FPIC WG by Indigenous Peoples, there was insufficient clarity on the status of the ICCPM implementation (full, in-part or absent) in the specific circumstance; relevant to establishing a causal relationship to the absence of FPIC of Indigenous Peoples.

   5.3. There are specific identified gaps within the ICCPM for the FPIC of Indigenous Peoples. These gaps relate to the absence of the explicit identification of Indigenous Peoples and their role in sound pesticide management as well as the absence of ICCPM definitions for FPIC and Indigenous Peoples.

   5.4. Addressing the specified gaps identified would, where the ICCPM is implemented in full, enhance the effectiveness of safe use of pesticides, which is expected to have a positive impact on Indigenous Peoples.

6. The WG **recommends** to the JMPM that FAO and WHO:

   6.1. Note the specific gaps identified by the JMPM in this report, detailed in Attachment 1.

   6.2. Consider the proposed amendments to the specific identified gaps as detailed in Attachment 1.

Introduction

7. Responding to the call in 2022 of the United Nations Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues (UNPFII), FAO's Committee on Agriculture in its 29th Session (COAG 29) in October 2024 requested FAO, in collaboration with WHO, to conduct a review of the *International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management* (ICCPM) through the Joint Meeting on Pesticide Management (JMPM).[1]

8. The review requested JMPM to assess the potential gaps of the Code as it pertains to paragraph 82 of the *Report of the 21st Session of the UNPFII*, which states:

   8.1. "The Permanent Forum calls on FAO and WHO to amend the International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management to take into account the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples" (para. 82).[5]

9. COAG 29 further requested that:

   9.1. JMPM findings of the review of the ICCPM must be science-, evidence-, and risk-based, consistent with the current Code.

   9.2. FAO to proactively consult in a transparent manner with members and key stakeholders throughout the process of review.

   9.3. FAO is expected to present the findings to the 30th Session of the COAG for consideration, as appropriate.

10. The JMPM meeting in October 2024 established a working group (the JMPM FPIC WG) for the review of the ICCPM with the support from a joint FAO and WHO Taskforce.

11. The JMPM FPIC WG presented a draft report to the 18th Meeting of the JMPM in October 2025.

JMPM FPIC WG operational premise

12. In considering if gaps within the ICCPM fails to take into account the FPIC of Indigenous Peoples, the JMPM FPIC WG noted that:

    12.1. The ICCPM is not a legally binding document and cannot apply legal restrictions or obligations on parties.

    12.2. The use of pesticides in manners inconsistent with the ICCPM can and do have harmful impacts on users, communities, consumers and the environment.

13. Within those two limits the JMPM FPIC WG specifically considered if the lack of overt and distinct processes to respect the FPIC of Indigenous Peoples within the ICCPM has resulted in, is resulting in, or is reasonably expected to result in, increased risks to Indigenous Peoples; and may therefore be indicative of gaps within the articles of the ICCPM.

JMPM FPIC WG operating framework

14. The JMPM FPIC WG was committed to the premise that the guidance in the ICCPM applies equally to all peoples, non-Indigenous and Indigenous Peoples, and that when implemented effectively achieves the safe and responsible management of pesticides for all.

15. The JMPM FPIC WG also acknowledges the potential for targeted improvements within the ICCPM to strengthen its operation for and with Indigenous Peoples and to support countries implementing the ICCPM to better deliver safe and responsible management of pesticides.

16. The JMPM FPIC WG was aware of examples presented to the JMPM in the past that were indicative that pesticides stored or used on Indigenous Peoples' territories may have produced, or contributed to, outcomes that do not achieve the safe and responsible management of pesticides.

17. The JMPM FPIC WG was also aware of instances where Indigenous Peoples in choosing to align with wider farming groups are denied these opportunities.

18. The JMPM FPIC WG acknowledges that in many countries there is a need to better include Indigenous Peoples´ views and voices in pesticide management practices; however, these should not conflict with guidelines and regulations for the proper use of pesticides.

19. The JMPM FPIC WG also recognized that within the ICCPM two distinct settings for the use of pesticides exist: i) agricultural (including home or small-scale production); and ii) public health (including personal protection and vector control).

20. The JMPM FPIC WG considered both settings concurrently unless specific rationale for distinction arose.

21. All information considered by the JMPM FPIC WG was to be science-, evidence- and risk-based, consistent with the task assigned at COAG 29. The JMPM FPIC WG adopted as an operating premise that all information presented must be objective and verifiable, any causal assertions must be supported by evidence beyond correlation.

Concurrent context

22. FPIC represents a single aspect of a broader framework for ensuring the rights articulated in the UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples. The JMPM FPIC WG, without diminishing the wider merits of the objective, limited its consideration to only matters relating directly to free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples in the ICCPM.

23. The ICCPM as a FAO and WHO endorsed document must be rooted in, and consistent with, the wider UN documents and internationally agreed instruments. The JMPM has taken regard to this reality in its deliberations, noting that the recommendations and operations of the JMPM need not be so constrained.

Considerations

Who are Indigenous Peoples?

24. Considering the diversity of Indigenous Peoples, a universal definition of "Indigenous Peoples" has not been adopted by the UN system. Instead, the system has developed a modern understanding of this term based on the following:

    - Self-identification as Indigenous Peoples at the individual level and accepted by the community as their member.
    - Historical continuity with pre-colonial and/or pre-settler societies.
    - Strong link to territories and surrounding natural resources.
    - Distinct social, economic or political systems.
    - Distinct language, culture and beliefs.
    - Form non-dominant groups of society.
    - Resolve to maintain and reproduce their ancestral environments and systems as distinctive peoples and communities.

25. Indigenous Peoples hold a distinct constituency as rights holders under international law, as provided by international instruments, including the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP). This distinctive status entitles them to collective rights that are indispensable for their existence, their well-being and their integral development as peoples.

26. The three United Nations Indigenous-Peoples' specific bodies, namely the United Nations Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues (UNPFII), the Special Rapporteur on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples, and the United Nations Expert Mechanism on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (EMRIP) have advised against conflating or equating Indigenous Peoples with non-Indigenous Peoples or entities, including minorities, vulnerable groups or "local communities" and requested that the UN Agencies follow this consideration.

Constituents and foundational elements of free, prior and informed consent

27. In terms of Indigenous Peoples, FPIC bears on the exercising of their right to self-determination, encompassing the ability of Indigenous Peoples to live free from coercion, to live in dignity, and to enjoy all rights equally. Entitlement to FPIC supports the ability to shape their own futures, to be fully informed, and includes the discretion to freely accept or reject any plans, projects, programmes, or proposals that may affect their lands, territories, and resources. Entitlement to FPIC of Indigenous Peoples operates as one of the safeguards for their collective rights.

28. All elements within FPIC are interlinked and were not treated by the JMPM FPIC WG as separate elements.

29. The free, prior and informed elements set the conditions of consent (as the last element) in a decision-making process.

30. The JMPM FPIC WG did not seek to establish a novel or pesticide-specific definition for the FPIC elements.

31. The JMPM FPIC WG adhered to the understanding of "free", "prior", "informed" and "consent" endorsed by the UNPFII at its Fourth Session in 2005,[6] and from the United Nations' Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation (UN-REDD) Programme Guidelines on free, prior and informed consent.[7] This adherence aligned with the contextual understanding of the UNPFII of FPIC in setting its request to FAO and WHO.

32. Specifically, the JMPM FPIC WG has taken "free", "prior", "informed" and "consent" to be:

Free

33. Free refers to a consent given voluntarily and without coercion, intimidation or manipulation. It also refers to a process that is self-directed by the community from whom consent is being sought, unencumbered by coercion, expectations or timelines that are externally imposed. More specifically:

    - Rights holders determine the process, timeline and decision-making structure.
    - Information is offered transparently and objectively at the request of the rights holders.
    - The process is free from coercion, bias, conditions, bribery or rewards.
    - Meetings and decisions take place at locations and times and in languages and formats determined by the Indigenous Peoples as rights holders.
    - All Indigenous Peoples, members of the nation, group or community that are affected are free to participate regardless of gender, age or standing.

Prior

34. Prior means that consent is sought sufficiently in advance of any authorization or commencement of activities, at the early stages of a development or investment plan, and not only when the need arises to obtain approval from the community. More specifically:

- Prior implies that time is provided to understand, access, and analyse information on the proposed activity. The amount of time required will depend on the decision-making processes of the rights holders.
- Information must be provided before activities can be initiated, at the beginning or initiation of an activity, process or phase of implementation, including conceptualization, design, proposal, information, execution, and following evaluation.
- The decision-making timeline established by the Indigenous Peoples must be respected, as it reflects the time needed to understand, analyse, and evaluate the activities under consideration in accordance with their own customs.

Informed

35. Informed refers to the nature of the engagement and type of information that should be provided prior to seeking consent and as part of the ongoing consent process. Information should be:

- Accessible, clear, consistent, accurate, and transparent.
- Delivered in the local language and in a culturally appropriate format (including radio, traditional/local media, video, graphics, documentaries, photos, oral presentations, or new media).
- Objective, covering both the positive and negative potential of the proposed activities and consequences of giving or withholding consent.
- Complete, including a preliminary assessment of the possible economic, social, cultural and environmental impacts, including potential risks and benefits.
- Complete, including the nature, size, pace, duration, reversibility and scope of any proposed project, its purpose and the location of areas that will be affected.
- Delivered by culturally appropriate personnel, in culturally appropriate locations, and include capacity building of Indigenous individuals or local trainers.
- Delivered with sufficient time to be understood and verified.
- Accessible to the most remote Indigenous Peoples' groups, nations or communities, including youth, women, the elderly and persons with disabilities, who are sometimes neglected.
- Provided in an ongoing and continuous basis throughout the FPIC process, with a view to enhancing local communication and decision-making processes.

Consent

36. Consent refers to the collective decision made by the Indigenous Peoples and reached through the customary decision-making processes of the affected Indigenous Peoples. Consent means:

- A freely given decision that may be a "Yes", a "No", or a "Yes with conditions", including the option to reconsider, if the proposed activities change or if new information relevant to the proposed activities emerges.

- A collective decision (e.g. through consensus or majority) determined by the affected Indigenous Peoples in accordance with their own customs and traditions through their own freely chosen representatives.

37. Consent implies the option of withholding consent in any moment and phase of the process.

38. Consent should be sought before any project, plan or action takes place (prior), it should be independently decided upon (free) and based on accurate, timely and sufficient information provided in a culturally appropriate way (informed) for it to be considered a valid result or outcome of a collective decision-making process.

Operational stages

39. FAO and WHO established a Taskforce (FAO/WHO Taskforce) to support the JMPM FPIC WG in information and evidence gathering. The FAO/WHO Taskforce comprised the JMPM Secretariat, along with representatives of legal and Indigenous Peoples units from both the FAO and WHO. Membership of the FAO/WHO Taskforce was at the discretion of the JMPM Secretariat and adapted to meet the needs of JMPM FPIC WG over the life of its operations.

40. Specifically, the JMPM FPIC WG through the FAO/WHO Taskforce obtained evidence or details of:

    - Relative impacts of pesticides exposure between non-Indigenous and Indigenous Peoples.
    - Legal findings which indicate that FPIC is rooted in international, regional and national legal instruments, and that there are judicial findings about the observance of FPIC of Indigenous Peoples.
    - Commentary on relevant legal information and framework at the international, regional and national levels with respect to conformance with ICCPM at the times relevant to the subparagraphs for relative impact exposure and legal findings indicating FPIC was not observed.
    - Published FAO and WHO normative guidance, including documents adopted by FAO and WHO Members; and policies and technical documents relevant to vector control or pesticide management that reference Indigenous Peoples and FPIC.
    - Protocols or practices from within United Nations bodies of effective FPIC of Indigenous Peoples, in particular the operations and assurance that consent is provided through their own freely chosen representatives.

41. The JMPM FPIC WG released a concept note on May 2025 outlining the intended work scope and timeframes.

42. The FAO/WHO Taskforce undertook broad consultation through:

    42.1. A survey on the experiences of Indigenous Peoples with pesticide management, including the concepts and practices of FPIC was released on 16 June 2025. The questionnaire was disseminated across the seven socio-cultural regions and made available in all six official UN languages. The FAO/WHO Taskforce analysis of responses was provided to the JMPM FPIC WG on 8 September 2025.

42.2. A side event was held at 2025 Expert Mechanism on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples to promote the UNPFII and COAG 29 actions, and seek engagement and submissions from Indigenous Peoples.

42.3. Circulation of the 18th meeting of JMPM endorsed draft to FAO members for comment.

43. Past submissions to JMPM on the impact of pesticides on Indigenous Peoples and their communities, and the reports of the Special Rapporteur on toxics and human rights were also relevant information for the JMPM FPIC WG.

44. Material prepared by the FAO/WHO Taskforce (identified as Appendices to this JMP FPIC WG report) to support the review of the ICCPM for gaps relating to the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples was reviewed by the JMPM FPIC WG on *prima facie* basis. The conclusions of the material were not endorsed by the JMPM FPIC WG and are not attributable to the JMPM FPIC WG or wider JMPM.

44.1. On specific matters, the JMPM FPIC WG acknowledged divergent positions from those of the FAO/WHO Taskforce. The JMPM FPIC WG was able to operate around this specific matter.

Considered information

General comments

45. The JMPM FPIC WG extends its sincere gratitude to the International Indian Treaty Council (IITC) for their past submissions including suggested locations within ICCPM where FPIC of Indigenous Peoples may be appropriate. This work was foundational to the working group deliberations; and informed the preliminary view that gaps of FPIC within ICCPM may exist.

46. The JMPM FPIC WG also expresses its gratitude to those Indigenous Peoples who have participated in the consultation process in all stages, and in their sharing of their experiences in and from pesticide management practices that as reported deviated from the best practice approaches of the ICCPM.

Survey

47. The analysis of the survey results completed by the FAO/WHO Taskforce was submitted to JMPM FPIC WG.

48. The FAO/WHO Taskforce processed and analysed the raw results. The responses will not be released to ensure that Indigenous Peoples' privacy and confidentiality are respected.

Health impacts from absence of FPIC

49. The JMPM FPIC WG initially sought to consider circumstances where ICCPM is followed and the lack of specific FPIC of Indigenous Peoples is resulting in negative health consequences for those peoples. The JMPM FPIC WG took into account over 273 responses, representing multiple countries, regions and distinct Indigenous Peoples.

50. For a variety of reasons, there was insufficient evidence to definitively establish causation between reported pesticide management activities (regardless of the degree of ICCPM implementation) and the apparent observed adverse outcomes.

Effective operation of ICCPM

51. The lived experience many Indigenous Peoples communicated through the survey responses, literature review and testimonies (collected and summarized by the FAO/WHO Taskforce and including input from UNEP, in Appendices B-D), made clear to the JMPM FPIC WG that they are likely indicative of deficiencies in the application, or potential absence, of the ICCPM.

52. The lack of overt of FPIC is likely to further hinder the effective operation of the ICCPM in pesticide management matters for Indigenous Peoples and their lands.

53. Specifically, the number of instances reported where the individual aspects of FPIC were not considered, or their outcome discounted when considered in their totality, was seen by the JMPM FPIC WG as evidence of actions that diminish the protections intended by the ICCPM.

54. The JMPM FPIC WG was concerned by those reported instances where some degree of consent was sought from Indigenous Peoples in relation to a pesticide management practice, and the action was undertaken in conflict with the Indigenous Peoples' decision.

55. The JMPM FPIC WG further considered the responses to the survey to be indicative of a potential concern regarding the full effective participation of Indigenous Peoples in safe pesticide management (as represented by the ICCPM) more generally.

International legal frameworks

56. The legal analysis of international frameworks was completed by the FAO/WHO Taskforce and was submitted to the JMPM FPIC WG.

57. The UNDRIP is the international instrument on the rights of Indigenous Peoples, establishing a universal framework of minimum standards for the Indigenous Peoples of the world and elaborating on existing human rights standards and fundamental freedoms as they apply to Indigenous Peoples.

58. The UNDRIP refers to FPIC frameworks to support Indigenous Peoples (Articles 19, 28, 29 and 32). While Article 19 makes specific reference to hazardous materials (including many pesticides), the reference in other articles speaks to the foundational nature of FPIC to the framework supporting the rights expressed in the UNDRIP.

59. The Indigenous and Tribal Peoples Convention of ILO of 1989 (ILO No. 169), entered into force on 5 September 1991. The ILO No. 169 relates to the collective and customary rights of Indigenous Peoples and is an important precursor to the UNDRIP.

60. The International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights and the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights recognize the right of peoples to self-determination, and that by virtue of that right to freely determine their political status and freely pursue their economic, social, and cultural development (common Article 1).

61. The African Charter on Human and Peoples' Rights of 1981 recognizes the right of all peoples to existence and self-determination (Article 20) and to be able to freely dispose of their wealth and

natural resources and the right to determine their economic, social and cultural development (Articles 21 and 22).

62. The American Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (ADRIP) of 2016 recognizes Indigenous Peoples' right to FPIC regarding projects affecting their lands, territories, and resources. ADRIP affirms that Indigenous Peoples have the right to self-determination (Article III) and in relation to health, cultural identity and redress mention the right to FPIC (Articles XIII, XVIII, XXIII, XXVIII).

63. The ASEAN Human Rights Declaration of 2012 refers to the right to development (Article 35), stating that all peoples have the right to participate in economic, social, and cultural development.

64. The JMPM FPIC WG concluded that the ICCPM to explicitly address FPIC of Indigenous Peoples in instances where the impact of an action would involve Indigenous Peoples to avoid doubt in the recognition of Indigenous Peoples' rights.

65. The JMPM FPIC WG further concluded that such amendments would be supported by international instruments.

Scientific literature

66. The JMPM FPIC WG was not presented with scientific literature, published or otherwise, that identified a distinction between non-Indigenous and Indigenous Peoples in health impacts from the application of pesticides in manners inconsistent with the ICCPM.

67. The JMPM FPIC WG acknowledges the established body of work showing harm to Indigenous Peoples from pesticides, but these lack context relative to the application of pesticide management practices and or comparisons to non-Indigenous Peoples under equivalent conditions.

Indigenous Peoples identified gaps

68. At the 16th meeting of the JMPM, the IITC presented an analysis of the ICCPM and identified gaps within it where, in its view, the explicit need for FPIC existed.

69. While acknowledging the IITC does not represent, nor does it purport to represent, all Indigenous Peoples, the JMPM FPIC WG considered the analysis to be, at a minimum, indicative of the views of Indigenous Peoples. The JMPM FPIC WG felt it was an invaluable resource.

70. The JMPM FPIC WG considered that its conclusions from the survey responses and review of the material concurred with the IITC analysis.

Findings and recommendations

71. In considering the information available to it the JMPM FPIC WG concluded that:

<u>Finding 1</u>

72. The ICCPM and its related guidance material, applies to all peoples equally; Indigenous and non-Indigenous.

Finding 2

73. In considering the harms from pesticide use or activities reported to the JMPM FPIC WG by Indigenous Peoples there was insufficient clarity on the status of the ICCPM implementation (full, in-part or absent) in the specific circumstances; relevant to establishing a causal relationship to the absence of FPIC of Indigenous Peoples.

Finding 3

74. Free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples is rooted in international, regional and national legal instruments, and there are judicial findings about the observance of FPIC of Indigenous Peoples.

Finding 4

75. There are specific identifiable gaps within the ICCPM where explicit reference to FPIC of Indigenous Peoples is warranted. These are detailed in Attachment 1.

    75.1. These gaps relate to the effective implementation of the ICCPM such that the protections intended by the ICCPM are delivered for Indigenous Peoples.

    75.2. The gaps span multiple articles of the ICCPM including those related to labelling, storage and use, and address matters that hinder one or more aspects of FPIC as understood by the working group, such as accessible information.

    75.3. Primary to these gaps is the absence of a definition within ICCPM of "Free Prior and Informed Consent" and its component elements, and of "Indigenous Peoples".

    75.4. No areas other than those detailed in Attachment 1 warrant action to address the FPIC of Indigenous Peoples.

Recommendation 1

That FAO and WHO prepare a response to the request of COAG 29 that identifies the specific gaps of the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples in the *International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management* as detailed in Attachment 1.

Finding 5

76. Addressing the specified gaps identified would, where the ICCPM is implemented in full, enhance the effectiveness of the safe use of pesticides, which is expected to have a positive impact on Indigenous Peoples.

    76.1. To this end, the JMPM FPIC WG, as an extension to the task assigned to JMPM by COAG 29 and to promote the rapid resolution of these issues and faster delivery of benefits to Indigenous Peoples, is proposing amendments to the text of the ICCPM.

    76.2. To facilitate COAG 30, the proposed amendments have been drafted in a style consistent with the existing ICCPM articles.

    76.3. The JMPM FPIC WG considers the proposed amendments to ICCPM articles to be focused, and those that are necessary to ensure the effective implementation of the ICCPM.

Recommendation 2

That FAO and WHO in the response to the request of COAG 29 make note of the proposed amendments detailed in Attachment 1, designed by JMPM, to address the specific identified gaps of the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples in the *International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management*.

Additional points

77. The JMPM further brings to the attention of FAO and WHO the following:

    77.1. Recognizing that the ICCPM is intended to apply to all peoples equally, if further consideration is to be given to the explicit rights of Indigenous Peoples within the ICCPM, such consideration should be applied holistically to all peoples.

    77.2. In general, Indigenous Peoples' unique circumstances are better addressed through nation-level documents and efforts rather than voluntary guidance material such as the ICCPM, as national efforts can be tailored to the unique circumstances for Indigenous Peoples. The specific nature of the task assigned to JMPM by COAG 29, in particular the timeframe, the defined resolution pathway and evidence standards, limited the effective operation of the JMPM FPIC WG.

    77.3. Future tasks of a similar nature should be developed in concert with the JMPM members, as distinct from the JMPM Secretariat, with the intention to provide latitude for JMPM to respond in a different manner.

    77.4. Specifically, this assigned task could conceivably have been more effectively addressed with a targeted Guidance Note rather than predicated on amending the ICCPM.

Attachment 1.

Gap analysis and proposed amendments for free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples in the *International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management.* Click here for the ICCPM

Article	Paragraph/reference	Recommended amendment
1. Objectives of the Code	1.2	Option 1: Add at the end of the paragraph "and Indigenous Peoples." Option 2: Following "such as environmental groups" add ", Indigenous Peoples,"
2. Terms and definitions	Public Interest Group	Add at the end of the paragraph "Indigenous Peoples."
	Vulnerable groups	Amend "Vulnerable groups" title to "Groups in situations of vulnerability" and following "HIV/AIDS affected people" add ", Indigenous Peoples."
	Include specific definitions for "Free", "Prior", "Informed" and "Consent"	Copy and insert, in full, the definitions from the United Nations Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues as specified at its fourth session in 2005.[1]
3. Pesticide management	3.2	Option 1: At the end of the paragraph add "Pesticide industry should work to ensure the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples is respected." Option 2: At the end of the paragraph add "Pesticide industry should work with governments to ensure the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples." Option 3: At the end of the first sentence add "and the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples for pesticide related matters."
	3.3	At the end of the paragraph include "including the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples".
	3.5.4	At the end of the paragraph Include ''where reasonably practicable, packaging and instructions should also be available in Indigenous Peoples' languages".
	3.6	At end of the paragraph include "or in Indigenous Peoples' territories.".
	3.8	Following "researchers, communities" add ", and Indigenous Peoples,"
	3.8	At the end of the paragraph add "Consistent with national commitments, governments should consult with Indigenous Peoples for the development of integrated pest management and integrated vector management."
4. Testing of pesticides	New sub-article (at 4.1.8)	Add a new sub-article …"4.1.8 ensure the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples prior to field trials or testing on Indigenous Peoples' lands and territories."
5. Reducing health and environmental risks	5.1.3	Following "occupationally exposed to pesticides" add ", in particular, to the peoples who live in Indigenous Peoples' territories that are exposed to pesticides,".
	5.1.4	At the end of the paragraph add "; as well as collaborating with Indigenous Peoples' healers, in the case of Indigenous Peoples, for the prevention of exposure and poisoning."
	5.2.2	At the end of the paragraph add "and in the case of Indigenous Peoples, where practicable, information about hazardous pesticides should be presented in a culturally and linguistically appropriate manner;"

Article	Paragraph/reference	Recommended amendment
	5.5.2	Option 1: Following "bystanders, nearby communities" add "and the lands, and territories of neighbouring Indigenous Peoples, "] Option 2: Following "bystanders, nearby communities" add ", Indigenous Peoples,"] Option 3: Following "bystanders, nearby communities" add ", Indigenous Peoples and the lands, and territories,"
6. Regulatory and technical requirements	6.1.1	Following "provisions of relevant legally binding instruments" add "Particular attention should be given to ensure the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples in relation to pesticide-related activities that may affect their territories, rights, or well-being."
7. Availability and use	7.1	At the end of the paragraph add *"Responsible authorities ensure the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples related to the use, handling, storage, or disposal of pesticides."*
9. Information exchange	New sub-article (at 9.4.3)	Add a new sub-article such that "All entities addressed by this Code should: … 9.4.3. Ensure the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples, including where it relates to supporting the transparency of information and information exchange, taking into account linguistic and cultural appropriateness to support Indigenous Peoples' meaningful and active participation and consent on matters regarding pesticide management."
10. Labelling, packaging, storage and disposal	10.3.1	Following "regulations (36, 37, 38, 49, 51, 53, 54, 55)" add "Article 29, paragraph 2 of the UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples,"
	10.3.1	Omit "guidelines" and replace with "instruments"
	10.6	At end of paragraph add "and what is established in Article 29 paragraph 2 of the UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples"
	New sub-article (at 10.9)	Add "10.9 All entities addressed by this Code should ensure that labelling and instructions are provided, where practicable, in an accessible manner for Indigenous Peoples, taking into account the diversity of languages and cultures."
12. Monitoring and observance of the Code	New sub-article (at 12.5.3)	Add a new sub-article "12.5.3. are encouraged to interpret provisions of the Code according to their international, regional and national obligations to support the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples."
Annex 1	Part B	At end of existing instruments add "United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples, and more specifically Article 29, adopted by the United Nations General Assembly on 13 September 2007" and "International Labor Organization Indigenous and Tribal Peoples Convention (No. 169), entry into force on 5 September 1991."

Notes:

1. United Nations. 2005. *Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues - Report on the fourth session (16–27 May 2005)*. E/2005/43-E/C.19/2005/9. Economic and Social Council. New York, USA. https://docs.un.org/en/E/C.19/2005/9

Notes

[1] FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations). *Report of the 29th Session of the Committee on Agriculture* (COAG), 30 September – 4 October 2024. Presented to the Forty-fourth Session of the FAO Council in Rome, 28 June - 4 July 2025. Rome. https://openknowledge.fao.org/server/api/core/bitstreams/6a819c57-9c5e-4d85-b287-a22ccb085124/content

[2] UNEP (United Nations Environment Programme). 2026. Global Framework on Chemicals. In: *UN Environment Programme*. [Cited 22 January 2026]. https://www.unep.org/global-framework-chemicals

[3] FAO. 2026. Reducing the Global Risk from Highly Hazardous Pesticides (HHPs). In: *Pest and Pesticide Management, FAO*. [Cited 22 January 2026]. https://www.fao.org/pest-and-pesticide-management/pesticide-risk-reduction/reducing-global-risk-from-hhp/en/

[4] UNEP. 2024. Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework. In: *Convention on Biological Diversity, UNEP*. [Cited 22 January 2026]. https://www.cbd.int/gbf

5 United Nations. 2022. *Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues - Report on the twenty-first session (25 April–6 May 2022)*. E/2022/43-E/C.19/2022/11. Economic and Social Council. New York, USA. https://docs.un.org/en/E/2022/43

[6] United Nations. 2005. *Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues - Report on the fourth session (16–27 May 2005)*. E/2005/43-E/C.19/2005/9. Economic and Social Council. New York, USA. https://docs.un.org/en/E/C.19/2005/9

[7] UN-REDD Programme. 2013. *Guidelines on Free, Prior and Informed Consent.* Geneva, Switzerland. https://un-declaration.narf.org/wp-content/uploads/2013unredd-fpic-guidelines.pdf

For further information, contact:

Global Neglected Tropical Diseases Programme
World Health Organization

20 avenue Appia
1211 Geneva 27
Switzerland

Website: https://www.who.int/teams/control-of-neglected-tropical-diseases

9789240120976